

Glorious Wisdom Drop: The Supreme and Wondrous King of the Yoginī Tantra

Śrī Jñānatilaka Yoginītantra Rāja Parama Mahādbhuta Nāma · Toh 422 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་ཡག་རྒྱལ་པོ་ཐཱ་ལཱ་ཤཱ་ལ་འབྱུང་མཁའ་འཛིན་ཀུན་ཀྱི་ལྷ་པོ་

Toh 422 in the Kangyur is a yoginī tantra known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Jñānatilaka Yoginītantra and in Tibetan as the Glorious Great King of the Tantra of the Yoginī of Wisdom Drop, Supremely Wondrous. It belongs to the class of highest yoga tantras centered on yoginī practice, presenting teachings that unfold in the context of the Blessed One dwelling in the bhaga of the vajra queen, surrounded by heroes and heroines — a setting characteristic of advanced tantric instruction. The text is specifically identified as the latter part of the latter section of a larger tantric cycle concerning the Great Seal Drop Yoginī, indicating it forms the concluding portion of an extended scriptural collection. It was translated from the Indian master Śrī Prajñāguhya and sits among the tantric scriptures of the Kangyur, the collection of canonical texts attributed to the Buddha himself.

The King of Kings is complete.

Translated from the mouth of the Indian master Śrī Prajñāguhya.

This is the latter part of the latter section of the Tantra of the King of the Great Seal Drop Yoginī.

In the language of India: Śrī Jñānatilaka Yoginītantra Rāja Parama Mahādbhuta Nāma.

In the Tibetan language: The Glorious Great King of the Tantra of the Yoginī of Wisdom Drop, Supremely Wondrous, So Called.

Homage to the Glorious Wisdom Drop.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One, the essential body, speech, and mind of all the Tathāgatas, dwelt in the bhaga of the vajra queen, surrounded by great heroes and the queens of the heroines.

There were present: Glorious Stainless Sky, Exceedingly Mighty, Lord of Gods, Master of Secrets, Blazing Light, Sun's Foe, Supreme Joy, Maker of All, Heart of the Utpala, Lord of Great Peace, Tamer of the Black One, Wondrous Hero, Greatly Proud, Great Black Subduer of Pride, Firm as Mount Meru, and Face of the Sky.

Among the queens of the heroines there were these: Moon Woman, Left Woman, Unequalled Woman, Deep Wind Woman, Bestower of Coolness Woman, Petal of the Heart Woman, Heedful Topknot Woman, Tamer of the Sun Woman, Peaceful Messenger of Death Woman, Green Zealous Woman, Light Aspiring Woman, Brahma's Woman, Viṣṇu's Woman, Lightning Mouth Woman, All-Generating Woman, and Mother of Heroes.

Among the noble queens of the mātṛkās (divine mother goddesses) there were these: Dry One, Terrifying One, Luminous One, Hanging Lip One, Tooth of Mount Meru One, Bliss-Maker of Time One, Sun Eye One, Fire Face One, Desire Woman, Long Tongue One, Dharma-Delight One, True Desire One, Thousand Eyes One, Tigress, Fierce One, and Desire Form Woman.

In the midst of a retinue of seven hundred and twenty million such chief ones — great heroes, queens of heroines, and noble queens of the mātṛkās — he dwelt engaged in the union of great supreme bliss. Then the Blessed One called out to the bodhisattva, the great bodhisattva Īśvara of Gods, and said: "Kye! Bodhisattva, great bodhisattva Īśvara of Gods — listen to the essence of the three realities, the supreme bliss of the moon, the extent of the Great Seal, and therein its own nature, aspects, and measures, as famed in the Glorious Wisdom Drop."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the bodhisattva, the great bodhisattva Īśvara of Gods, together with all his retinue, circumambulated three times, bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, gazed at the ground, and sat without saying anything.

At that moment, from the sky there fell before the feet of the Blessed One many showers of jewels and various fragrant flowers of every kind: māṇḍārava flowers, great māṇḍārava flowers, utpala flowers, sun-equal radiant blooms, water-born flowers, paṇḍarīka flowers, aśoka flowers, campaka flowers, arjuna flowers, and nāgakeśara flowers and the like.

Again the Blessed One called to the bodhisattva, the great bodhisattva Īśvara of Gods, and said: "What has astonished you?" Īśvara of Gods replied: "Blessed One — I am astonished wondering whether there is, in the three realities, such a thing as its own nature, its measure, and its aspects." Then the supreme Vajradhara addressed the great hero Īśvara of Gods as follows.

How wondrous! Is there, at the limit of the three suchnesses — their own essential nature, the supreme bliss of the moon, and the Great Seal — some intrinsic character, some aspect, some measure? Or is there not? If there is

not, how could one know this emptiness of intrinsic nature that is the nature of all phenomena? All phenomena are the supporting condition, the mere cause of a flash before the eye. Just as fragrance arises in dependence upon musk, and without the actual substance of musk no fragrance could be found, so too: if intrinsic character, measure of phenomena, and aspects were absent, there would be no finding of the essential identity of the three suchnesses, the supreme bliss of the moon, or the body of the Great Seal.

Therefore, in the distinction between that which pervades and that which is pervaded,

the great bliss is non-dual.

Because bliss abides in dependence on the body,
when one relies on bliss, one becomes that very suchness.

If the body of bliss is consciousness,
all is the reality of non-duality.

The six blisses are the supreme gnosis;
bliss and body arise from the two.

Dwelling at the center of the six wheels,
it is the supreme essential identity of the three suchnesses —
the intrinsic nature of the moon and so forth, the inseparable self —
renowned as the cause of the three suchnesses' identity.

Relying on the body, in the vital staff,
the gnosis of the six practices abides.

At the center of the hub of the six wheels,
in the subtle body there are six channels;
with the bindu, these are conjoined
within the vital staff.

At the hub of the Wheel of Great Bliss
is the moon-consort endowed with life —
she is the root of the vital staff,
in the manner of a triangular form.

At the hub of the Wheel of Perfect Enjoyment
is the tongue-consort endowed with bliss —
she is the location of the vital staff,
resembling a flower of the lineage.

At the hub of the Dharma Wheel
is the sky-consort endowed with gnosis —

she is the heart of the vital staff,
in the form of the eye of a peacock.

At the center of the Emanation Wheel
is Radiant Dawn, the consort of the moment —
she is the location of the vital staff,
in the form of a fully opened lotus.

At the heart of the Fire Wheel
is Blazing Light, the consort endowed with desire —
she is the limbs of the vital staff,
clearly manifest in the form of a vajra.

At the hub of the Wind Wheel
is the consort endowed with diligent strength —
the end of that vital staff
resembles a sesame flower in bloom.
She is the consciousness of the six practices,
endowed with channels and with bindu.
Because she is embraced by the non-conceptual mother,
she is then the Brahmā staff.

Its time, as I have explained, is twofold:
the rising and the setting.

When the Brahmā staff has thirty-two knots — sixteen that move below the navel, and sixteen that move above — since the awakening mind and the vital wind encounter one another and radiate, the channels of conjunction that connect what is above and below as a single reality number thirty-two. The awakening mind, endowed with joy, in the form of a bracelet ring — whose identity of body, speech, and mind is a single unity — the non-conceptual, blissful, perfect mother of mind embraces the Brahmā staff, and from the uṣṇīṣa of great bliss down to the jewel-mouth of secret great bliss, as far as the Wind Wheel, it is like the great emanation present in the sandalwood tree of Gośīrṣa.

Now, Īśvara of Gods, how shall one's intrinsic character be described? The very first triangular-formed knot of the essence of the Brahmā bone-staff, endowed with the vital wind of the navel, is the awakening mind — a bindu of light at the navel of the wisdom-consort — and within one hour of the first day of the waxing moon, the joy of desire arises. Possessed of trembling desire arising

from the fruit of the lotus, approaching near, up to two hours of the second day, strength declines.

From the gathering of the fierce eye, endowed with the equanimity of beings, up to three hours of the third day, it is the time of the arising of the bindu of cloud. From the touching of the breast of the flower of the lineage, endowed with joy moving upward, up to four hours of the fourth day, it sets. From the drinking of the nectar of the eye-tears of Brahmā, given as a gift, endowed with expansion moving downward, up to five hours of the fifth day, it is the time of the arising of the breath. From the scratching of the nail by the conch-eye, endowed with the aspect of fierce terror, up to six hours of the sixth day, it is the time of the setting of the blue lotus. From the union of the ear-eye, endowed with the pervading wind arising therefrom, up to seven hours of the seventh day, it is the time of the arising at the crown of the head. From the stirring of the fruit by the eye, endowed with the four supreme joys, up to eight hours of the eighth day, it is the time of the setting of the mind. From the tight embrace of the navel of the conch breast, endowed with the loosening of the blazing, up to nine hours of the ninth day, it is the time of the arising of the essence. From the rumbling sound of the navel-throat of the great elephant, endowed with a bindu possessing edges, up to ten hours of the tenth day, it is the time of the setting of the moon. From the milk of the eye of the navel of the blue lotus, endowed with intoxicated cranes, up to eleven hours of the eleventh day, it is the time of the arising of the sun. From the shaking and churning of the navel of the lotus, endowed with wrathful Krodhā, the joy free from joy, up to twelve hours of the twelfth day, it is the time of the setting of the fierce. From the town of the bee's mouth, endowed with the uṅga that does not blink, up to thirteen hours of the thirteenth day, it is the time of the supreme arising. From the contraction of the peacock's mouth, endowed with the opening of the way, up to fourteen hours of the fourteenth day, it is the time of the setting of the sound. From the equal union at the mouth of the vajra, endowed with the arising of sleep, up to fifteen hours of the fifteenth day, it is the time of the arising of taste. From the sesame flower in full bloom crying out "Ha!", up to sixteen hours of the sixteenth day, it is the time of the setting of the summit, endowed with the clarity of simultaneously born joy.

Now, the summit is the mantra that causes terror, and for it, sixteen are the settings. In whatever case of arising or setting, the simultaneously born does not exist within it. At the center of the navel of the channel in the form of a

crooked bracelet is the bindu, and the arising of joy and so forth — that is the time of setting.

Such is the form of great bliss. I have taught it as the transference. The actual, the support, and the differentiation — wisdom, joy-free, simultaneously born, always dwelling. The actual is the equal-taste view of things. It purifies attachment and desire. The actual of gathering and touch renders existence nonexistent. The enjoyments of milk and embrace — the actual utterly severs things. By means of the source of the white lotus, relying upon the triangle and so forth, the support is inconceivable — it is the essential nature of the dharmadhātu. The support of the above and below being equal renders nirvāṇa free of conceptuality. The support of the nectar of great bliss is the supreme foundation of the five lineages. Wisdom and desire arise spontaneously — trembling, joy, supreme joy — wisdom and awareness arise spontaneously — the simultaneously born without foundation. With foundation, the joy free from joy — wisdom renders pride absent. Knowing all phenomena, wisdom accomplishes the aim of what is to be known. The differentiation is renowned as the form of light — the nature of conduct, cloud, and power. The differentiation throughout all things — the foundation of aspects together with it dissolves. The differentiation of arising and abiding, magical illusion — it slays delusion. In cakra, mantra, and activity, the subduing one is that differentiation. All the essences of the channels —

Because of subduing, the differentiation arises. The ultimate boundary of the essence of wisdom — the differentiation is the offering. Because wisdom renders all supremely blissful, the differentiation is therefore declared. Non-dual, supremely peaceful — neither with attachment nor without attachment. Unstained, uncontrived, free from tantra, mantra, and stages. Self-aware and inexpressible, pervading all things and without minor marks — such is the ultimate truth. The differentiation of the sovereign of the gods: it dwells eternally in the hearts of all the awakening minds of the buddhas and bodhisattvas. In the differentiation there is no meditation. Free from the aggregates, elements, and so forth. Empty of phenomena such as sound and the rest. Its very nature is emptiness and compassion. Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Rudra, and Īśvara — eternally peaceful — all of these its fathers. The differentiation and the supremely wondrous arising: in this very wisdom-sphere the lord of supreme accomplishments abides. Present within all elements, it is the supremely excellent nature of the five bodies. The five lords who are sovereign dākinīs — of the nature of space, unborn. Dissolved within the five spaces.

Worshipped by all buddhas — such is the great secret wisdom. The lord of wisdom, difficult to find: just as a thief strives to conceal a treasure not yet found, so this is hidden with effort.

This concludes the first chapter of the Glorious Wisdom-Sphere, entitled "The arising and the cessation of the time of the transference."

The lord of the gods (Īśvara) then posed his question: Kyai! Blessed One, what is the resonance of the triad of suchness? Likewise, what is the supreme bliss of the moon? What is the form of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā)? And what is its ultimate boundary?

The Blessed One declared: The triad of suchness is body, speech, and mind — the threefold vajra, the supreme wisdom. As for "the supreme bliss of the moon" — its aggregates, sense faculties, and elements; the Great Seal is the vajra-essence. Its ultimate boundary is remembered in the bhaga. The boundary and the luminosity, consciousness — seen like the reflection of the moon in water. All phenomena are by nature unstained. All things arise from luminosity. There is no birth and no cessation. All things arise from true light. The identity of all outer phenomena beyond this is the Blessed One, the Glorious Wisdom-Sphere. For it, there is first the meditation on the arising, the cultivation of the maṇḍala-wheel with forms, together with mantra and recitation, fire offering and consecrated offering, tormas and offerings, the declaration of the sacred place, and the sequence of empowerment — all of these are taught. This concludes the second chapter of the Glorious Wisdom-Sphere, which sets forth in part the nature of the triad of suchness, the bliss of the supreme moon, the ultimate boundary of the Great Seal, and related topics.

The lord of the gods then asked: Regarding the upper and lower transference along the staff of Brahmā's bone and the life-force — in the two parts, from the nature of the thirty-two channels, what was taught in the first chapter singles out one alone among them: the single mind of thought-free well-being and bliss is definitively indicated. But Blessed One, for what purpose are the other channels not taught here?

The Blessed One declared: That single thought-free, blissful, and wholesome sacred commitment is taught in order that the network of the seventy-two hundred thousand subtle channels may serve as an instrument of music, and that inconceivable diverse nectars may rain down and arise upon the ground of the great dharma-source. The lord of the gods then asked: Even so, I beg

the gracious instruction of the supreme lord concerning the names and enumeration of those thirty-one channels. The Blessed One declared: Lord of the gods, listen now to the names of the thirty-one. They are: the Secret one, the Profound one, the Craving one, the Subtle one, the Nectar-mother, the Nectar-maid, the Pure one, the Blissful one, the Powerful one, the Method-one, the Hrudhrudhā-mother —

the Yellow one, the Milk-stream one, the Joyful one, the Oily one, the Wrathful one, the Sweet one, the Sour one, the Needle one, the Warm one, the Hot one, the Salt one, the Rough one, the Faith one, the Powerful one, the Joy-maker, the Joy-giver, the Sleep one, the Cut-and-birth one, the Digest one, and the Life one. These are the thirty-one channels. At the time when the moon and sun above and below, as they stream forth, are seized by the eclipsing planets, they become fully engorged at their junctures.

Then the sequence of empowerments is explained:

However the order may be arranged,
whoever has obtained the supreme empowerment
will become capable in all respects.

A son endowed with qualities and ethical conduct
should first be given empowerment by the master.

Having bathed, cover the eyes with a pure cloth,
hold the cupped hands filled with flowers,
and having offered gifts with joy,
the lord of the gods bestows the empowerment.

Through the act of empowerment, the ground of buddhahood
is obtained without doubt.

Therefore strive at all times with diligence
and receive the glorious sovereignty of empowerment.

The empowerment divided into four
represents the distinction beginning with the ācārya empowerment.

The first is the ācārya empowerment,
the second is the secret empowerment,
the third is the wisdom-gnosis empowerment,
and the fourth is likewise in that same sequence.

The four, divided by two, making eight,
are conferred as the ācārya empowerment and so forth.

The vajra ācārya empowerment I have explained

as threefold, equal in extent to the sky itself.
For those two, eleven are performed.
The vajra ācārya is the sovereign of empowerments.
That empowerment is a precious jewel;
the three realms bow in reverence to it.
For the purpose of attaining liberation,
I have set this out here in sequential order:
water, crown, vajra,
bell, name, vow,
prophecy, conferring refuge,
mudrā, mantra, and gnosis.

For those inclined toward the tantra of yoga,
the eight empowerments divided are to be given.
For those inclined toward the yoga master,
the eleven themselves are to be given.
For those inclined toward the yoginī,
the secret empowerment is given.
The secret is said to be divided into two:
outer and inner.
For the sake of yoga and the yoga master,
one who knows the empowerment should confer it.
For the inner stream of the yoginī,
the secret empowerment is supremely conferred.
That secret is further divided into three:
arising, knot, and likewise awakening.
Wisdom is divided into two aspects:
the distinctions of the generation and completion stages.
A wisdom consort of eight or sixteen years,
skilled in the expansive domain of the eye,
fragrant with sandalwood scent at her limbs,
satisfied by supremely gentle fluid,
beautiful in form, dark-complexioned, and fortunate,
with firm and supple breasts, tall in stature,
devoted to meditation and mantra, peaceful —
one accomplished through the compassion accompanied by empowerment.
One of such renowned excellence should be sought with diligence.

Request the master on account of the empowerment.
She who is endowed with all those defining marks —
whether a wife, a sister,
a daughter, or a daughter-in-law —
the skilled one should strive earnestly to take her.
One who is young together with the generative fluid,
adorned beautifully with varied ornaments,
is to be offered by the skilled one to the master.

The pith instruction of the empowerment resides in three.
The inner one points by way of symbol.
The fourth is known as the embodiment of the fruit.
Free from those three, it is itself the master of three.
The distinction concerning joy and so forth
is set out clearly by the vajra maiden.
Through empowerment one becomes a wheel-turning sovereign
and comes to be so without doubt.
Empowerment renders one stainless,
just as cloth is washed clean by water and so forth.
The empowerment in which all rites are complete,
together with those very same limbs,
is transmitted sequentially one to the next
and is received from the lips of the highest master.
Otherwise, one who is skilled only in the assembly of reasoners,
ever devoted to grammatical treatises —
the supreme empowerment in its three aspects
should neither be received from them nor given by them.
If one desires the genuine fruit,
all of that should be abandoned entirely.

Just so, even if one presses a great heap of gathered sand with tremendous effort, not even half a drop of butter will emerge. Likewise, when one who is endowed with much reasoning and a net of mere words is taught —
— from hearing it, nothing other than affliction alone will be gained as a fruit.
Therefore, the one who knows the empowerment obtained through sequential transmission from one to the next is the vajra master, the great guru.

The auspicious one of the supreme unmanifest,
the giver who bestows the fruit of buddhahood —
this is none other than the form of the guru.
The abode of all merit,
worthy of worship by buddhas, bodhisattvas,
Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), Viṣṇu, and all the gods —
though unknown, this is the form that is renowned.
Knowing this to be so, the practitioner
should worship with diligent effort.
Having made offering before the face of the guru,
one obtains whatever fruit one desires.
One who knows the meaning of tantra
and the meaning of empowerment,
yet does not make offering to the guru —
as long as sun and moon abide in the sky,
that one will go to the Avīci hell.
Therefore, always and with diligent effort,
worship the guru with reverence.

Excellent offerings fashioned from various precious things —
golden lotuses free of stain,
pearl garlands beyond all price,
robes of many and varied kinds,
beloved queens together with their children,
great elephants, horses, and servants and the like —
all these should be offered with steady faith and devotion
in the presence of the glorious guru.

This concludes the third chapter of the Glorious Wisdom-Drop, entitled "The Sequential Empowerment Together with the Presentation of Offerings."

Now listen further — another excellent teaching:
the true meaning of what is found at the seat.
Possessed of a single pillar and nine doorways,
adorned with vajra-built ornamentation,
encircled entirely by vajra lines and upper borders,
it is distinguished in sequence by wind and the rest,
and endowed with the four elements.
Extending to every horizon of space,
the self of all things ever dwells therein.

In the center of the vajra tent,
the protection wheel turns and revolves —
ten-spoked, of golden hue,
accompanied by ten wrathful ones.

All the wrathful ones have three faces, three eyes, and six arms. They stand with the right leg extended, with massive bodies. They are adorned with serpent ornaments. Their tongues are curled back, their fangs bared in a terrifying grimace, their yellow hair standing upright, their eyebrows and eyelashes arched and long.

On the spoke of the eastern wheel: the form of Yamāntaka (the Destroyer of Yama), dark black in color, with two faces — the right yellow and the left red. In the two right hands, a sword and a trident; in the two left hands, a skull-cup and a club.

On the spoke of the southern direction: Prajñāntakṛt (the One Who Brings Wisdom to its End), white, with the right face red and the left blue. The two right hands hold a club and a sword; the two left hands hold a single-pointed weapon and a head.

To the west: Padmāntakṛt (the Destroyer of the Lotus), red, with the right face white and the left blue. The four hands — right and left — hold a sword, a wheel, a half-moon, and an eight-sided Mount Meru.

To the north: Vighnāntakṛt (the Destroyer of Obstacles), blue, with the two faces — right and left — white and red. The four hands — right and left — hold a vajra-cross, a sword, a short lance, and a conch.

At the southeast, the fire direction: one bearing the form of Kāmarāja (the King of Desire), with the two faces — right and left — white and red. In the two right hands, a sword and a jewel; in the left hands, an axe and a short lance.

At the southwest, the rākṣasa direction: the blue-club holder, of the form of a yellow makara-holder. The two faces — right and left — green and red. In the two right hands, a three-pronged cross and a sword; in the two left hands, a great sāla tree and likewise fire.

At the northwest, the wind direction: the Greatly Powerful One, smoky in color, with the two faces — right and left — yellow and red. In the four hands: a sword, a conch, a battle-axe, and a tail.

At the northeast, the Īśāna direction: Acalā (the Immovable Protector), white and black, with the left face red and the right blue.

In the four hands, right and left: a sword, an iron hook, a lute, and a small drum. Above is the Wheel-Turner with the Uṣṇīṣa (Cakravartī-Uṣṇīṣa), yellow in color, with the two faces — right and left — blue and white. In the four hands: a wheel, a sword, a skull-cup (kapāla), and a khaṭvāṅga staff. Below is the King of Sumbha, sky-blue in color. The right face blazes with the radiance of deep indigo; the left shines with the radiance of the youthful sun. In the two right hands: a sword and an iron hook; in the two left hands: a curved knife and a skull. The two root hands of all hold a vajra and a lotus, embracing his own wisdom-light consort. The King of Desire and the rest are above the eight world-protectors. The Wheel-Turner with the Uṣṇīṣa and the King of Sumbha should be understood as being above the moon and sun respectively.

The hub of this wheel is triangular in form — the white-radiance source of phenomena (dharmodaya) of the moon-bearing one. In its center, by the sequential arising of the four elements as previously described, from the complete transformation of Vairocana, there arises the great expansive palace endowed with eight charnel grounds. On a sun-seat, at the hub of a lotus of eight variegated petals, above Heruka (the Terrifying One) and the Bliss-Bestower of the Auspicious Moment, arising from the two — vowels (āli) and consonants (kāli) — whose very nature is flow and drop, from the syllables Māṃ and Hūṃ: glorious Wisdom-Drop (Śrī-Jñāna-Tilaka), embraced by the great seal (mahāmudrā), with eight faces and eight arms, the right arms extended. The four faces are: black, yellow, red, and green. The other four are like petals of a blue utpala lotus. The implements are: a vajra, a bell, a small drum, a skull-cup, a khaṭvāṅga, a sword, and a bow and arrow. Adorned with a hair-ornament of variegated vajras and crescent moons in a crest of matted locks, and on the forehead above the protuberance, wearing the crown of Akṣobhya. The body is bound by six mudrā-seals, adorned with a great necklace of strung entrails for a garland, wearing a loincloth of Brahmā's skin around the waist — thus the body stands. With a great roar of the laughter "ha ha!" and the loud searching cry of "phem-kara," by mere utterance he causes the skulls of beings as numerous as the grains of sand in ten million Brahmā-worlds to burst open. He dances with the nine dramatic expressions of the terrifying one in the eight great charnel grounds of black fire, amid the terrible and the hideous, hosts of jackals inspiring dread, and flesh-eating hordes cackling wildly.

This concludes the fourth chapter, called "Generating the Maṇḍala-Wheel from Glorious Wisdom-Drop."

Now shall the supreme mantra be explained;
The practitioner shall succeed thereby.
An excellent level place, perfectly flat,
Anoint it with honey and camphor.
Strew fragrant flowers upon it.
Scatter them with blossoms.
By a riverbank or on an open plain,
Encircle it with vajra-cord.
The beautiful-eyed vajra-maiden,
Full of lotuses in sun and moon,
Fresh in youth, soft to the touch —
First let the skilled one enter her.
At the place of mantra, according to the tradition,
Let her be properly and skillfully conjoined.
Whatever arises from that union
Offer as worship — the mouth, the earth, and the rest.
Make an eight-petaled lotus.
Ten vajra-pegs —
Let the skilled one set them with the fierce mantra.
Having equalized āli and kāli,
Arrange them in sequence on all the petals.
One āli on the wisdom-petal,
The kāli recalled on the seven petals.
On each petal, five syllables;
The fifth five on the five.
On the second petal, four and two —
The syllable Kṣaḥ is at the inner hub.
Vowels and consonants separately:
Āli and kāli are the perception of them.
From the syllables of these two upon the petals,
Recall that very king of mantras.
The sovereignty of the king by the form of the first;
Then, at the beginning of the second petal,
Accompanied by the vowel of the fourth,
Adorned below by the letter ra —

Then twenty-five:

The fourth of the second petal.
Possessing the second vowel,
It purifies the lower realms of the wrathful.
The fourth of the first of the two petals.
Then adorned by a consonant,
The second of the first of the two petals.
Every possessing one chases away epidemic.
Third among the consonants,
Perfectly joined with the tenth.
Adorned by the lordship of the gods with the second vowel.
The fifth of the fourth, whatever it is,
Then the first of that.
The sixteenth joined with the third.
All are the foundation of the words of mantra.
Then the letter sa, pure,
And likewise the first consonant.
Thirty-three consonants as a branch,
Joined perfectly with the sixth vowel.
The foundation of the arising of all.
Adorned with the bindu of the lunar digit —
That one abides close to it:
The supreme syllable, sovereign of mind.
That which is the second of the fifth
And is joined with the first of the third,
Ending with svāhā —
The essence mantra, supreme and wondrous.
The supreme of forms first,
The fourth of the second petal.
Below, possessing the longing syllable,
Joined with the fourth vowel.
The supreme syllable, king of vidyā —
Its head pressed by a bindu.
That abides near to itself.
The ultimate peace, supreme of all peace.
Pressed by a drop, thirty-three,

The sixteenth joined with the second.
Again that very same supreme syllable
Clears away the darkness of the three realms.
Hūṃ Phaṭ — both of those combined.
At the end joined with svāhā.
This is called the close essence mantra,
The Blessed One's wisdom bindu.

First, Vairocana,
Then twenty-nine.
The consonant is four-two,
Joined with twenty-seven.
The other of twenty-two,
Joined with the seventh vowel.
Third from the fourth.
And close to that is wind.
Possessing the eleventh vowel,
It grants the aims of all results.
The fifth of the fifth,
Close to the syllable ha.
The third of the fifth,
Then twenty-eight.
The first of the fifth,
Then twenty-seven.
Joined with the second vowel,
It is able to draw in the three realms.
The first consonant
And the twenty-seventh joined.
Twenty-five,
Joined with the second vowel.
Twenty-six, the supreme syllable,
Joined with the eleventh vowel.
Ending with svāhā,
Extended with Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ.
This is the great mudrā heart essence,
The equal radiance of the wish-fulfilling jewel.

Praṇa of the first,
Then the third of the second petal.
The second division of the ya group,
Then twenty-nine.
The third vowel:
Let it enter into the heart.
Sixty-four and a half, pure,
Equal to the syllable ra.
At the end joined with svāhā,
Extended by Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ.
The great mantra of the close essence,
The supreme lord of all mantras.

Oṃ śrī mahākaruṇākṛta matā bebeda sphāraṇa mahākalāntāgne samprabha
jaya vijaya aṭṭāṭṭahāsa mahāghoraghopeśvara mahāvīravīreśvara
mahārudhirāṃtramāladhara saumā sūryāgni locana ākāśodara
mahāsāsagaṃkoggo hana hana daha daha paca paca matha matha
vidhvaṃsaya vidhvaṃsaya ākarṣaya ākarṣaya bhāṃjaye bhāṃjaya cūrṇaya
cūrṇaya ha ha ha ha hi hi hi hi mahārudhira pāṇimardāya hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ
phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ mahākrodheśrārāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ
mahāvaibede sphāraṇāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ mahākālpānta agniṣma
prabhāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ jaya vijaya aṭṭāṭṭahāsāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ
mahāghoraghopeśārāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ mahāvīreśvarāya hūṃ phaṭ
svāhā.

Oṃ mahārudhirāntamāladhārāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ
saumasūryāgnilocanāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ ākāśodarāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
Oṃ mahāsāsagarakokkeni hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ hana hana hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
Oṃ daha daha hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ paca paca hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ matha
matha hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ vidhvaṃsaya vidhvaṃsaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ
ākarṣaya ākarṣaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ bhāñjaya bhāñjaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
Oṃ cūrṇaya cūrṇaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ ha ha ha ha hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ hi
hi hi hi hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ mahārudhirapāṇimardāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ
hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ hūṃ phaṭ
svāhā.

The mantra of the garland is the supreme deity:
it accomplishes perfectly every single action.

Oṃ mahākāmarūpiṇīye sar sar, visar visar, āgaccha āgaccha, sarvārthaṃ sādahaya sādahaya, sarvāmāraṃ nirmatha nirmatha, mahāvīre vīreśvara sapta pātāla, vadareṇe, saptasāgara, śuṣaṇe ruṣaṇe muhana, jambhane, stambhane, trelokya bhayaṃkare, haṃ haṃ hiṃ hiṃ hūṃ hūṃ, kili kili, sili sili, hili hili, ḍili ḍili, mahākha gne samaprabhaāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

The mantra of the garland is the supreme deity,
taught by me, the Blessed Lady herself.

Ha dhūṃ dhūṃ, kruṃ kruṃ, ghrauṃ ghrauṃ, mrom mrom, jrom jrom, ṭāṃ ṭāṃ, praṃ praṃ, srom srom, trom trom, ṭuṃ ṭuṃ, phrom phrom, brom brom, yom yom, hrom hrom, śrom śrom, kuṃ kuṃ.

The mantra of the wheel is the great mantra,
the supreme heart-essence of the heroes (vīras).

A ā i ī u ū ṛ ṛ ḷ ḷ e ai o au aṃ aḥ.

The heart mantra of the limbs of the heroines,
the sovereign lord of the gods — this I now explain.

At the beginning place oṃ, at the end hūṃ phaṭ,
and in the middle expand the name.

The arrangement of the secret mantra
is to be offered at the time of worship.

Oṃ nādanirmālāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vandyurthagame hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ mahākālāgrāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ nadamātrasvarūpāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ paraśurūpāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ aparāmaṇa buṃgāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

The sovereign mantra of the six wisdoms,
dwelling within the sixth wheel,
the lord-king of the secret maṇḍala —
with this mantra worship is to be performed.

The sounds a, ka, ca, ṭa, ta, pa, ya, śa resound:
these are the chiefs of the eight groups.

Torma offerings for the root groups are to be made
exactly as set forth in the two tantras.

Through the vajra mudrā or the heart-essence,
offer with an unwinking gaze.

The mantra of the wrathful one who stands in the protection circle —
that mantra I now explain.

Jrembha jrembha. Ghughuro ghughuro. Dhara dhara. Vidhara vidhara. Ṭagheṭ ṭagheṭ. Spholiṃgi spholiṃgi. Aṭa aṭa hāsa. Aṭṭa maṭṭa hāsa. Hūlu hūlu. Vikrama vikrama.

It is sealed at the end with hūṃ phaṭ,
and in the middle the name is expanded.

The third vajra is the sovereign of wisdom:
oṃ āḥ hūṃ is the supreme mantra.

This concludes the fifth chapter, entitled "The Glorious Wisdom Drop: The Extraction of Mantras."

Then the offering-fire of supreme bliss is taught.
It is performed in sequence with the site and so forth.
The three drops are the particular forms of the generation stage;
the three stages of completion are likewise so.
Consciousness and the rest, distinguished one from another,
make up the great domain of the Brahmic offering-fire.
Consciousness, enjoyment, appearance, space, and wisdom —
these are distinguished according to the eight bodies,
differentiating things, their supports, and their forms.
Whatever is wished for and pleasing —
that is the offering-fire of the yoginī maṇḍala.

At Auryana and the other sacred sites,
Legs-dges-ma and all the other goddesses —
Kālī bestows the supreme wisdom syllable.
This is to be performed outwardly and inwardly.

When the offering-fire is made, the giving is great,
and auspicious fruit is born.
For sentient beings, in their particularity,
the manifold methods have been fully taught.

For some, it is the method of making offerings;
for others, it is the way of the sūtras;
for some, it is the path of the perfections;
for others, it is the supreme way of mantra.
According to the distinction of higher, middling, and lower,
these are the methods for proceeding to liberation.

Even those of great intelligence, through other vehicles,
become buddhas only after three incalculable eons.
But one who is devoted to the mantra vehicle
becomes a buddha in this very life.

Or again — you need say nothing of being a Vajradhāra yourself,
or you, yoginī.

Or else, upon the moment of abandoning the body,
the unsurpassed primordial wisdom —
even one who lacks diligence will find it.

What need is there to speak of one endowed with diligence?

Through steady diligence, all aims,
even without striving, are accomplished.
One who has the merit by which all aims are fulfilled
is free from conceptuality and free from affliction.

Whatever action one performs,
that is an increase of merit.
Whatever enjoyments of desire one enjoys,
all of those count as offerings and the like.
That is an increase of the offering-fire.
From offering, the fruit of wisdom is obtained.
That is the true offering-fire —
rare to find throughout all the tantras —
and it bestows all great fruits.
It is the supreme basis of the yoginī.

This concludes the sixth chapter of the Glorious Wisdom-Drop, entitled "The
Ritual of the Offering-Fire."

Then the ritual of worship:
it destroys all evil.

With the mind-captivating divine flowers,
endowed with the radiance of moon and sun,
with fire and with wondrous lamps,
one should make offering to the offering-fire maṇḍala.

The empowerment is on the first day of the waning fortnight,
by the first of the sixteen phases.

The second is the full absorption of the third —
by the last of the first sixteen.

The third is enjoyment,
by the third of the sixteen.
The fourth absorption arises
by the last of the third.
The fifth is enjoyment,
by the fifth of the sixteen.
The sixth absorption arises
by the sixth of the sixteen.

The supreme empowerment of aspiration —
on the eighth of the waning fortnight —
is to be offered with the eight vowels.
The ninth gives rise to enjoyment,
by the ninth of the sixteen.
The tenth absorption arises
by the tenth of the vowels.
The eleventh is empowerment —
one is to make offering by the eleventh.
The twelfth absorption arises
by the twelfth of the vowels.
The enjoyment of the thirteenth
is to be offered with those two.
The fourteenth brings absorption —
offered with the seventh and eighth vowels together.
On the full moon is the empowerment —
by the fifteenth vowel.

The offering is the arising of the awakening mind.
In the waxing and waning fortnights, respectively,
wisdom and skillful means are supremely conjoined.
The maṇḍala of the wisdom of the three bodies —
through dates, syllables, and mantras —
the moon-bearer waxes and grows.
By the cessation of the sky of drops,
that intrinsic nature comes to arise.
The wisdom that is the intrinsic nature of the drop —
even all the buddhas find it hard to obtain.
Through my kindness, the intrinsic nature is swift:

it is found without a doubt.

That fool who does not know the self,
who is forever devoted to coarse meditative concentration —
all of those will achieve nothing.
This is the truth of the lord of the gods.

Lord of all grounds, sovereign ruler,
lord of all grounds, powerful sovereign,
king of the lord of all grounds —
self of all, inner self of all,
pervading all, forever empty,
worshipped by all the buddhas,
renowned as the intrinsic nature of wisdom and skillful means,
the self-nature plays in what is gone-and-not-gone.
Supreme space, without boundary —

free of defining marks, free of ground —
hard to find even for the lords of the gods, even for the lords of power,
even for the Vajra-bearer.

I encompass the boundary of Dharma and enjoyment.

The natures of gnosis and consciousness —
the Vajra-bearer and all the buddhas,
the lord of the gods is easily found.

The gnosis-body of the supreme aspect —
that is not easy for anyone.

This is the seventh chapter, entitled "The Ritual of Worship from the Glorious
Wheel of Gnosis."

Now, what is next to be taught.

Fire sacrifice destroys evil.

There is the peaceful, the enriching,
and likewise the magnetizing and the wrathful.

The fire-pit for the peaceful is round.

For the enriching, it is four-sided.

The magnetizing takes the form of a bow.

The wrathful is three-sided.

White, yellow, then red,
and black — in that order.

Ocean, fire, eye, moon —
these are the measures for the lord of the gods.
One by one in sequence for all the rest:
when the previous is accomplished, the next does not fail.
In each fire-pit, a lotus at the heart-center —
the sequence of the rites of the family.

Above that, the variegated vajra
endowed with five rays of light.
In the navel, the fire deity:
three faces and four hands,
golden in body, with round eyes,
adorned with a crown of matted locks,
with blazing fangs, greatly terrible,
seated in the vajra posture.

On the right, three pennants and a counting rosary;
on the left, a staff and a ladle.

At the heart-center, the fire deity
with seven tongues, luminous, shining forth.

Lord of the jeweled crown, possessed of virtues —
he is fire at the center of the sphere.

Come hither, greatly radiant,
master who accomplishes all that is desired.

Oṃ bhūr bhuvaḥ svāhā.

Great self-arisen Blessed One,
lord of desire, granter of desires —
fire deity who accomplishes all actions:
abide close by me here.

This is the mantra for invoking the fire deity.

Then the water offering, the contact offering, and the scattering-and-drinking.

Oṃ hrīṃ hrīṃ — the mantra of the water offering.

Oṃ bhī bhī — the mantra of the contact offering.

Abhokṣa abhokṣa — the mantra of the scattering-and-drinking.

Then the offering of a seat. Forming the fingers into a chain-link gesture,
assuming the form that joins the middle ones —
with the ring finger and the eye in particular,
the little finger and thumb together rounded —

this is the mudrā for offering a seat.

The skilled practitioner should first draw all the materials close.
However they are obtained without difficulty,
let that serve as the excellent accomplishment of the reality itself.
The master of accomplishment, endowed with qualities,
greatly learned in mantra and tantra,
singularly devoted to the repetition of mantra,
with an undistracted and lucid mind.

The way of the sphere is great gnosis;
knowing particulars, the lineage of the precious.

The five maidens of the five families —
satisfied with the fluid of the hungry ghosts —
she of the long eye and the pure one,
holding the breasts firmly, soft and high,
dancing at the place of fire sacrifice,
naked and with hair unbound.

To accomplish the aim of the fire sacrifice rite,
the maidens of the five families are to be admitted.

By the rite of wisdom and skillful means,
the guru himself makes the offering first.

The apprehension of the examined and the unexamined —
that is not to be engaged in here.

For those seized by conceptual elemental beings,
various skillful means have been taught by me.

In the ultimate, there is no external object;
it is not the internal either.

Free of particles, utterly free of particles,
parted from both emptiness and non-emptiness,
self-knowing in nature, parted from self-knowing —
it is not found by the path of speech.

Aggregates, elements — these are conceptual.

That which burns the lord of the gods —
that, in the ultimate reality of fire,
abides in the body yet is not born from the body.

All is complete in the supreme aspect;
it abides within all phenomena.

In its conventional aspect, as form,
the lord of the gods is the imputed nature.
Through union of the imputed nature with gnosis,
the ground is found in stages.
Therefore, with effort in every way,
as the cause of the supremacy of all aspects,
for the accomplishment of one's own and others' aims —

Perform the fire offering, the burnt offering, the torma offering
for the increase of the accumulation of merit
and for the benefit of sentient beings — do these things.

Barley, sesame, rice husks, wheat, boiled rice, black-eyed peas (bokaliga),
white mustard seed, all medicines, nutmeg (jātīphala), the fruit of the coconut,
śrīphala, nāgakeśara, saffron, sandalwood, camphor, milk, yogurt, porridge,
clarified butter, laddu, dried fruit and the like, bdellium (guggula), shellac
(śaila), white bdellium, the ten-limbed compound and similar substances,
flowers, incense, butter lamps, fragrant substances, torma cakes, arrows, silks
and the like — together with all these, and for each of the directions and
intermediate directions of the hearth-maṇḍala, all the vases are to be adorned
with various medicines and mouth-ornaments, filled in their bellies with
fragrant water, and their necks are to be adorned with silks of various colors.
This is to be performed for all activities beginning with pacification.

For the activity of enrichment, the light of gold —
examine everything thoroughly with all of these.
For the activity of power, everything in red light —
set aside the yogurt and the milk.

Black mustard seed and the skin of a black snake,
the beak of a raven,
the heart of a black crow,
brain, intestines, feet, and the head —
all are of black color,
together with the tails of dogs,
black mustard oil, great oil,
the ground of hungry ghosts, oil,
singed cloth, and the cotton of hungry ghosts,
burnt bones, burning wood,

sharp, excellent thorns,
thorn flowers, and āmalaka,
black porridge, unmixed —
examine these thoroughly for the fierce activity.

Conceive, other than these, the sovereignty of the hero.
Perform this for the fierce activity and the rest.

One's own suchness — pacification and the rest.
Adorned with mudrā seals and the like as ornaments.
Pure ghee in the east, unstained.
Firewood of flower-trees, free from defects —
fresh, dry, and fragrant,
without smoke and free from defects —
for all of them, one cubit in measure.
Let the one skilled in the activity perform accordingly.

The wood too — yam wood — is taught.
One obtains it by whatever effort one can make.

Śamī, śamoka, śambaka, aśvattha, plakṣa,
nyagrodha, dūrvā, apāmārga, pippalā, khadira,
campaka, aśoka —
these are of eight fingers' measure.

The ladle for pouring, the pouring ladle, the vessel of ghee —
as taught through the precious analogy.

The stirring stick — one handspan in measure.

With effort, make the pouring ladle.

As the pouring ladle, so the receiving ladle;
the vessel for the melted butter is not equal to those.

Triangular and round in shape,
adorned with the vajra form.

The mouth of the pouring ladle —
six fingers in measure.

The head, likewise, make it the same.

Make everything square all around.

At the center, a varied vajra at the heart,
the navel adorned with a lotus.

At the tip, coming from the mouth of a makara,

a nine-pointed vajra
placed at the rim of the pouring ladle.
The eye of the receiving ladle is similar —
or else it is a lotus.
The interior is deep and clear,
neither too long nor too short.
Inside, it is adorned with fine vajra patterns.
The vessel for melted butter is known as round,
with a long navel, without stain,
adorned with vajra and similar ornaments —
avoid what is too heavy or too light.

I have taught the four distinctions
for pacification and the rest in particular.
Those six are to be performed in a charnel ground for the fierce activity,
on a riverbank for the activity of power,
in the center of a field for the enrichment activity,
or else in a great monastery.
Pacification is in a town
or else in a royal court.
Horses, great elephants,
maidens, calves and the like —
at the time of the fire offering, with effort,
the mantra practitioner should present these to the master.
Even to the poor, the downtrodden, and the lowly,
one should give according to one's ability.

This concludes the eighth chapter of the Śrī Jñānabindu, entitled "The Ritual of the Fire Offering."

Now, furthermore, what is to be explained:
The great torma of the gaṇacakra assembly —
the dwelling is in a three-story house,
free from all thieves —

Neither outer nor inner is the domain.
Adorned with a gathering of masters,
with vajra arrows and various forms depicted,
encircled with vajra threads and the like —

such a supreme dwelling
should have all its maṇḍalas made complete
with varied flowers and the like,
beautified with Śrī Lankan camphor.

There, for the sake of the fire offering,
a creature of excellent form is to be selected:
one who is one, two, or three
life-births old, in the prime of youth,
free from every disease, endowed with well-being,
bearing the fragrance of fine dust,
one whose eyes are long and slightly closed —
with effort the skilled one should select such a being.

With the varied fire offering,
examine it with an appropriate curved blade.
A lotus-vessel of the finest limbs —
for the purpose of drinking, placed before the master.
Half is to be marked upon the wheel,
and half is to be cast into the torma.

Great blood and great flesh —
whatever is found is what is to be examined.
The other kinds are varied and supreme,
possessed of fish and meat and the like,
free from harm and free from all fault,
without sin and unprovoked.

The great alcohol is present,
adorned beautifully with song and music.
Mixed with five lamps,
it is thus endowed with the five Tathāgatas.
In the midst of variety, the supreme limb,
filled and placed before the maṇḍala.

Just as at the time of offering to the master
the mudrā of reality is bound,
so too with varied things as well,
one should bind it with one-pointed focus.

Whether standing or sitting,
one bows to the lord of the assembly.
With a voice most melodious and beautiful,
an enchanting song is to be sung.

Not with doubt and not in verse —
vajra dance is not to be performed without permission.
Extending the legs and lying down —
these are not to be done in the assembly wheel.

As the glorious Vajrasattva truly is,
so is the glorious Karmavajra.
Whatever he does and whatever he says —
the skilled one should strive and accomplish that.
If it is otherwise, a downfall descends.

To the extent of one's ability,
the pure commitments (samaya) there
are always to be guarded as one's very self.
If the commitments are guarded, what is accomplished
is the attainment of lordship over the gods.
The gnosis of the supreme commitment —
always consume it with faith.
Having taken hold of the joyous commitment,
the family, together with the wheel, is supremely satisfied.
Having brought about supreme satisfaction, offer the tormas
at midnight, at the fourfold crossroads,
or at a three-way fork where paths diverge,
or at a charnel ground or on a riverbank.

The remainder, or else the first portion —
all these are mixed together and purified with water.
All the others are set apart separately,
arranged in proper order according to the root.

By the mere fact of having returned to one's own place,
examine a single vessel for the wheel.
A single portion for the master
is to be guarded with effort.
It should not be given to one's own assembly,
and likewise for conferring autonomy.

The mudrā dance of the left limb —
with the left hand is the offering.
Having bent the left foot,
with the left eye one should look.

Now, should a yoginī arrive at that time for the purpose of examination, one should not be afraid, but examine her thoroughly in the manner of a lion. And so every yoginī manifests varied forms, varied mudrās, and varied voices.

When, from a great distance at the very outset, she laughs and shouts "Ha ha!" — at that time, give her the mudrā of victory over the three realms. At that time the five syllables of "Ha" are to be pronounced with a great sound.

When she comes somewhat closer, say "A la la."

When at the moment of encounter she circles her hand, at that time raise the arm upward with a pointing finger.

When she parts her eyebrows, at that time roll the tongue in a frightening manner.

When she gazes upward, press down with the left extended leg.

When she looks from behind, press down with the right extended leg.

When she is wildly agitated, at that time say "Phemkara."

When she weeps, at that time laugh.

When she dances, at that time stand tall and erect.

When she lets her hair loose, at that time untie the topknot.

When she throws off her clothes, at that time rise up and urinate.

When she drinks urine, at that time pull up grass with the left big toe.

When she asks a question, at that time do not speak.

When she tugs at you, at that time tie a knot in the hair.

When she touches the forehead, at that time touch the very end of the upper boundary.

When she touches the ear, at that time touch the throat.

When she touches the nose, at that time thrust out the tongue.

When she bares the throat, at that time extend the arm.

When she bares the breasts, at that time rub and move the eyes.

When she bares the navel, at that time give a snap of the fingers.

When she sways the hips, at that time display the mark.

When she stretches out the legs, at that time raise the two little fingers upward, and likewise with the index finger and the eyes. Between the nostrils let the middle tongue come forth naturally, and extend the right leg and the left leg.

When she shows a form of many kinds, at that time recite the mantra of the ten wheels.

When she speaks the meaning of a syllable, at that time reply with the syllable.

When she repeats herself, at that time speak the word for flesh.

When she says "banner of victory," at that time say back "mark."

When she says "lotus," at that time say "womb."

When she says "plowshare," at that time say "hand."

When she grasps at what is desired, at that time say "rice."

When she says "fever medicine," at that time say "food."

When she says "life," at that time say "moon in water."

When she says "gain," at that time indicate "mind."

When she speaks of displeasure, at that time indicate the path.

When she says "anger," at that time drink ale and speak again.

When she says "slaughter," at that time say "rest."

When she says "steadfast," at that time say "sleep."

When she speaks of time, at that time say "joy."

When she says "moon," at that time say "clothes."

When she says "I recall the sun," at that time say "thirst."

When she says "fire," at that time say "shadow."

When she says "fish," at that time say "come."

When she utters the sound of a song, at that time say "gold."

When she says "chaff," at that time say "carry."

When she says "corpse," at that time say "earth."

When she says "pride," at that time say "wind."

When she says "lake," at that time say "good."

When she says "arrow," at that time say "lawbreaker."

When she makes the sound of attachment, at that time say "come."

When she says "drink milk," at that time say "go."

When she says "miserliness," at that time say "accomplished."

When she says "lie down," at that time say "not present."

When she says "grain," at that time say "again, virtue."

When she says "flourishing," at that time say "scented water."

When she says "hare," at that time say "great fragrance."

When she says "plowshare," at that time say "cliff."

When she says "cold," at that time say "semen."

When she says "moon," at that time say "meeting with joy."

When she says "palāśa tree," at that time say "weariness."

When she says "Sindhu," at that time say "not at leisure."

Otherwise, one should know the root meaning of one's own letters.

A woman who has large hands and feet — send her to the left.

Women who have yellowish eyes and a diminished nose — place them on the right side.

Women who have a long nose, long hands and fingers, and much body hair — offer them three sesame-balls in front of them.

Women who are dark in complexion, whose lower abdomen hangs down, whose breasts are pendulous, and whose teeth are large — spit in front of them.

Women who have yellowish hair, round eyes, long nails, and a long neck — let out a great laugh in front of them.

A woman who is as white as the flower of the campā plant, whose voice is gentle, whose eyes are long, whose teeth are like a row of hills, who is fond of sweet fragrance, who smiles just slightly, who glances sideways, and who acts

in such a way while not remaining still — in front of such a one, say nothing at all, look at the ground, and move swiftly to the left side. At such a time, one should recite the heart mantra and count the rosary.

A woman who holds one finger — the index finger — extended, who looks with delight at blue-colored forms, whose garment hangs down over the edge of her shoulder, who displays in the center of her brow, directly, a hand-seal in the shape of a lotus, or in a coiled form, or else with a tip resembling the tender shoot of an aśoka tree — together with that gesture, one should strive with effort to unite with her. For she accomplishes all things, produces all results, and generates great joy. Together with her, one should offer a great torma for the benefit of all sentient beings, giving it without conceptual grasping and with a vast and open mind.

In vessels of the very widest kind,
arrange them according to the rite.
In the center stands the glorious fearful form,
adorned with ornaments of various bones.
Filled completely with great blood,
a skull-cup in the right hand.
The Great God (Śiva), bearing manifold forms,
rising up, with the left hand.
The fierce, black fire-form — east.
The Great Black One — to the south.
The terrifying one — to the west.
The greatly fierce one — to the north.
At the fire-corner: the fierce, matted one.
At the water-corner: the one with a black club.
At the wind-corner: the fierce risen corpse.
The powerful Heruka — dark.

Skin-head, Crying One, Fierce One, Skull-One, Black One, Śālī, Savage One, Lineage One, Thirsty One, Sow, Śabarī, Brahmin Woman, Three-Matted-Lock One, Fierce-Matted One, Fierce-Eyed One, Painful One — gathered turning clockwise and counterclockwise, the vessels are arranged in order while moistened.

On the outer circle, they are surrounded by the eight World-Guardians along with their many retinues. The eight great nāgas. Male messengers, female messengers, male attendants, female attendants, and their retinues. Ḍākas,

many dākinīs, many māṭṛs, spirit-beings, hungry ghosts, flesh-eaters, the maddening ones, the forgetting ones, and the malevolent ones beyond count —

Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ!

Be pleased! Be pleased! Maintain your samaya pledges! Drink! Accomplish all my actions! Hold the samaya! Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ Phaṭ Svāhā!

This is the ninth chapter of the Glorious Jñānabindu: the rite of the gaṇacakra, the great tormā, the defining marks of the yoginī, the secret words, and the code of hand-seals.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, Lhāṃi Dbang Phyug (Īśvara of the Gods), rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, bowed his head to his feet in prostration, and spoke thus:

O Blessed One, sovereign lord of wisdom's glory,
you have taught the maṇḍala in brief —

How precisely is this definitive teaching to be given here? Great sovereign lord, please declare it!

The Blessed One then spoke: The definitive teaching of the maṇḍala, exactly as it is — hear it, O hero! From the meaning of the tantra taught before: from the great bliss of the vowels and consonants, from the syllables Māṃ and Hūṃ, the manner of the bindu; from those two arise the curved knife and the lotus; from the wisdom-fire's light arises wisdom; born from the melting of the essential nature of the quintessence — one of colour equal to a rain-cloud, adorned with eight pairs of hands, the face most terrifying with the sixteen half-portions, supremely beautiful with four feet, doing homage with twenty-four eyes, destroying the dense darkness of the three delusions. With faces white, yellow, and red, the upper face bearing a wrathful, bee-like form; with one leg extended to the left and one extended to the right, pressing with great force upon the terrifying moon and sun. Bearing the terrifying skull-cup filled with blood held in the hand, wearing as the supreme garment the peaceful flayed hide, two hands raised upward, the skirt fashioned from the hide of Brahmā, the body bound with six mudrās, joined with the great seal and non-dual union. Abiding in Brahmā's conduct endowed with dance, consuming the lands and soils of Brahmā's realm, adorned with the faces of Brahmā's realm. The great seal is the blue of the sky; the second pair of hands

with garments loosened; holding a curved knife and a vessel, with a peaceful face; three-eyed and hair unbound; embracing at the throat the supreme secret. In the nature of the hero he abides. The form delighting in the highest hero. Adorned with a crest of manifold vajras. The protector with a manifold crescent-moon diadem. Possessing manifold Brahmā's wine. Seated upon a manifold lotus throne. Being of manifold nature, arising manifoldly. Adorned with manifold bone ornaments. Beautified with garlands of manifold heads. Endowed with the flavour of manifold dance. Cutting through manifold delusion. The protector who is the master of manifold illusion. Conquering manifold illusion.

In the midst of the eight charnel grounds, surrounded by hero-yoginīs, endowed with the eight world-guardians, encircled by the eight kings of trees — the maṇḍala's two outer offerings of delight. Here I, Īśvara of the Gods, take my delight. The maṇḍala of heroes and yoginīs — just as I myself sport here in this: now rejoice in it in sequence. Listen with one-pointed mind! First, then, one outer section, adorned with pillars at the gates and so forth, in the sequence of the abodes and the adjacent abodes. I, Īśvara of the Gods, now explain.

In the east petal of the manifold lotus, in the sacred site of Oḍḍiyāna: Spotless Sky, and the Moon, of dark colour. In the north, at Jālandhara, Very Mighty, and to the left, White Woman. In the west, at Pullīra, Īśvara of the Gods, and Equal-to-the-Sun, of red complexion. In the south, at Kāmarūpa, Lord of Secrets, and Vāyu-Consumer, of the colour of a blue lotus. At the fire-corner, at the adjacent site of Mālavā: Blazing Light, and Bestower of Coolness, of green colour. At the yakṣa-corner, in the land of Sindhu: Pure Form, and the Petal of Quintessence, of a colour like a dark-blue lotus. At the wind-corner, at Nagara: Offering-Delight, and Heedful Crested One, white as the moon. At the corner of the Powerful One: Maker of All, and Sun-Tamer, like the rays of the sun. At the eastern gate, in the field of Mummuni: Heart of the Blue Lotus, and Blue Great Peaceful Messenger of Death. At the northern gate, at Devīkoṭa: Lord of Great Peace, and Saffron-coloured Striving-in-Green. At the western gate, at Nearby Kulūta: Black Tamer, and Seven-Lights, of smoky dark colour. At the southern gate, at Arbuda: Wondrous Heroine, and Mother of Brahmā, of smoky colour.

At the south-eastern corner, at Caṇḍohāharikila: Great Fierce One and Vyāpinī, of cloud colour. At the northern corner, at Kuṭa: Subduer of Pride, of golden colour. At the western corner, at Nearby Caṇḍohāralāmā: Meru-Steadfast and All-Producing, of dark red colour. At the southern corner, at Kañcika: Sky-Face

and Mother of the Hero, of golden colour.

All are locked in the embrace of the union in which skillful means and wisdom are inseparable, and they are alike in body colour and posture. The heroes have four faces and four arms, holding a khaṭvāṅga, a skull-cup, a bell, and a small drum. They are seated upon lotus thrones of the multicoloured vajra, above that a seat of the terrifying one, in the royal posture, pressing down the moon and sun with their feet, blazing with the brilliance of ten million suns within the fire maṇḍala, radiating illumination.

In the second ring, there are multicoloured eight-petalled lotuses, with gates and staircases and the like, endowed with eight charnel grounds. On the eastern petal of that, at the gathered place, in the field of the Activities: Dry One, of cloud colour. To the north, at the Golden Isle: Great Red Fearful One. To the west, at the Nearby Gathering of Kulūta: Red Luminous One. To the south at Rabni: Drooping-Lip, of the colour of palāśa. At the fire-corner, at the charnel ground where hungry ghosts gather, at Meru's Edge: of moon colour. At the yakṣa-corner, at the river bank: Temporal Bliss, of the colour of lamplight. At the wind-corner, at the Nearby Charnel Ground of Cariṭa: Sun-Eyed One, of golden colour. At the corner of the Powerful One, at the City of Youth: Fire-Face, of refined gold colour.

At the eastern gate, at Pilavakā in Smīra: Mother of Desire, of yellow colour. At the northern gate, at Kirāta: Long-Tongued One, white in colour. At the western gate, at the Nearby Pilavakā in Nepal: Dharma-White, white as the moon. At the southern gate, at Kambaja: Banner-Coloured, of emerald colour.

At the east-corner, on the eastern path, in the Eastern Continent Videha: Thousand-Eyed One, of vajra and sapphire colour. At the northern corner, in the Northern Continent Uttarakuru: Tigress, of lapis lazuli colour. At the western corner, in Godānīya: Fierce One, of musāragalva colour. At the southern corner, on the Nearby Path, in Jambudvīpa: Form of Desire, of variegated colour.

All the yoginīs (Skt. yoginī) have four faces, three eyes each, and four arms, with hair and garments loose, holding a sword, a skull-cup, a khaṭvāṅga, and a small drum. They are seated with the left leg extended upon a corpse. Alternatively, one may visualise them in the royal posture, embracing their own luminous method, adorned with bone ornaments.

Such a maṇḍala, sovereign among maṇḍalas,
is rarely encountered in any tantra.

Body, bhaga, and awakening mind —
these three maṇḍalas are supremely excellent.

Or else the essence maṇḍala is taught.
In order to take up one's own bliss:
the syllable Ma is recollected at the petals,
the syllable Na is recalled at the navel,
the syllable Ḍa is at the filaments,
the syllable La is like bliss there.

The syllable Ma is known as Precious Fame,
the syllable Na is uttered at the knot,
the syllable Ḍa is the object of the long one,
the syllable La is uttered at the mouth.

The syllable Ma is the form of Venus,
the syllable Na is the object of melting,
the syllable Ḍa is endowed with light,
the syllable La is the form of bliss.

Ma is known as the perception of luminosity,
Na is the spreading of the syllable of luminosity,
Ḍa is luminosity obtaining luminosity,
La is the supreme, perfectly stainless one.

The syllable Ma is known as joy,
the syllable Na is recalled as supreme,
the syllable Ḍa is joy apart from joy,
La is recalled as innate.

The syllable Ma is called such,
the syllable Na is indicated as water,
the syllable Ḍa is indeed fire,
the syllable La is the form of wind.

Because of movement it is called wind,
or alternatively it is recalled because of pervasion.

Because gnosis is obtained,
one receives great bliss.

The essential nature of gnosis is great bliss,
perfectly dwelling in the maṇḍala.

The maṇḍala, the buddha, the precious and supreme —
the essential nature of the bindu, free from syllables,

all aspects, yet without aspect,
free from mudrā and from mantra.
The great mantra, the path of the grove of delight,
free from vowels and consonants,
stainless, uncontrived,
without reason and without ground,
perfectly stainless, an abode utterly pure.
Renowned by its intrinsic nature, unborn as space,
the self renowned as the essential nature of the hero,
perfectly abiding in all aspects.
I am the maṇḍala and the one within the maṇḍala,
I am the lord of the maṇḍala,
I am the hero who holds and who hears,
I am the doer, the one who seizes, the sovereign lord.
I am the intrinsic face of all phenomena.
Emptiness and compassion are not two —
great emptiness is renowned as one's intrinsic face.
I am that which is nowhere apprehended.
It is not a thing; it should not be conceived.
Even the self of things is not that suchness.
Liberated from thing and non-thing,
I, the self, am the nature of thing and non-thing.
From thing and non-thing both it arises;
within thing and non-thing it is present within.
Just as the sap within dry wood,
just as the oil within the sesame seed,
just as the fire within the tree —
so does the self dwell within all things.
Nevertheless, the wisdom bodhisattva
should not grasp at a self.
Grasping at self is a great affliction
that degrades one from the benefit of sentient beings.
There is no merit other than
the benefit of sentient beings
that is anywhere greater.
Working for one's own benefit is not merit.

The great being, knowing this,
abandons the unsuitability of self-interest.
One whose mind is the śrāvaka mind — diminished through aversion toward
others —
is overpowered by grasping at self-interest through delusion,
and turns away from the benefit of sentient beings.
One who desires great accomplishment
should not dwell together with such a person,
nor even speak with them,
for they are frightening, lacking in skillful means.
Even if adorned with jewels upon the head,
they are to be cast away like a black serpent.
Never be with such a śrāvaka.
Indeed, even an assembly of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) is superior.
Just as a broken pot of poplar wood
is of no use anywhere —
so too a śrāvaka whose ethical conduct is broken:
when they expound the view of their own Dharma,
yet it is stained with defilement,
they are of no use at all.

A bodhisattva, even if their discipline is damaged,
does not incur a downfall thereby,
provided they hold correct view and act for others' benefit —
being endowed with such skillful means,
they are not tainted by fault,
just as a lotus is not tainted by water.

Toward a non-Buddhist or a śrāvaka,
even one who is inferior — do not show contempt.
One who has reached the limit of the wisdom maṇḍala
should not, out of faith, make offerings to them.

The yoginī who abides in the single outer branch,
dwells in this maṇḍala.
Always with flowers, incense, and the like,
make offerings with this mantra.
Om̐ at the beginning, Hūṃ Phaṭ at the end —
in between, the name is to be extended.

With the fire offering of the fivefold variety,
make extensive offering to the place of the maṇḍala.
When the offering is made, without any doubt,
great accomplishment will be obtained.

This concludes the tenth chapter, entitled "Meditating on the Maṇḍala
Accompanied by Aspects, from the Glorious Wisdom Bindu."

Then again the bodhisattva, the great being Īśvara of the Gods, bowed his
head at the feet of the Blessed One and spoke thus:

O Blessed One, sun of gnosis,
who opens the lotus of the heart —
whatever I ask of you,
speak to me with great compassion.

Regarding the recitation of mantra, fire offering, worship, empowerment, a
brief introduction to the abode, the homa, and the rites of the great torma —
grant me, O Blessed One, the teaching of the definitive meaning on these.

The Blessed One declared: The definitive meaning of mantra recitation — hear
it; I shall explain it correctly.

It arises from joy and so forth.

Mind is what is called mantra.

Again, it is the mantra of churning and having been churned.

Mantra is taught as nectar (amṛta).

Liberation along the path — that is mantra.

The elaborated syllables are likewise so.

It abides in the middle between the two that meet.

That is the mantra of ultimate meaning.

Mantra is the vowel series and the consonant series.

The utterance of that is recitation.

In generation, completion, and in their particularity,
the recitation of mantra is supremely renowned.

Wherever the two — the upper and lower channels —
move not in motion,

present within the root of the vital breath,

the unceasing stream of what is proper and what transcends the proper:

the three spheres (bindu) and the three letters

are to be uttered as self-luminous and unmodified.
The tongue is to be inserted within the channel,
and pressed down with the tip of the tongue.
Again, it touches with the tip.
Through the meditative concentration of the aspect of union,
like a nectar of renowned efficacy,
the mode then arises.
In the particular sequence of emanation,
the body of bliss in which the sphere is drawn up,
adorned by the maṇḍala of the homa offering —
its generation phase I have explained.

Glorious Vajradhara
performs the homa dwelling in the abode of delight.
The homa from which supreme joy arises
is to be performed in that supreme maṇḍala.
The supreme joy is taught as circular;
the characteristic of wisdom is the consonant series.
The homa of the self-nature of the eight bodies
is to be offered at the eight abodes.
The arising of the yoginī in accordance with reality —
its meaning I shall now explain.

By the thirty-two letter-forms,
and chiefly through the spheres of the consonant series,
by the sovereign faculty of meditation — at the abodes and so forth —
she is to be worshipped together with the goddesses.
All the goddesses, the abodes and so forth,
and the sovereign lord of the gods — these are the refuge.
The goddess here is the root;
she is the source of arising and the ground of abiding.
She is the complete fulfilment of the refuge,
endowed with major and minor marks.

At the center of the triangle stands the Blessed One,
her hue like that of the blue lotus (utpala),
seated in the center of a multicolored lotus throne,
enthroned above the four māras.
Sixteen faces, sixteen arms;

each face has three eyes.
Yellow, red, and green faces;
the moon-marked face circles to the left,
all the other faces dark as bees,
the uppermost face fearsome.
Wrapped in the hide of Yama, Lord of Death,
for the purpose of sacred vow and for the aim of ascetic conduct,
she wears a garland of buddhas as a necklace,
adorned with a pendant braid upon the head,
possessed of the taste of the nine dances.
The body is beautiful with six mudrās,
adorned with varied bone ornaments,
blazing with the radiance of varied lights.
The wisdom ḍākinī of great bliss,
the perfect one of delight, the sovereign woman — in non-dual union.
Smeared with charnel-ground ashes,
stretched above, she rests in bliss.
The right leg extended, she is endowed with dance,
signaling the abode of the secret meaning.
Encircled by the assembly of ḍākinīs,
she abides in the midst of the eight charnel grounds.
Vajra and bell — non-dual union.
Covered with the skin of Brahmā.
Bow and arrow, precious wheel,
sword and trident, small drum,
moon and sun, axe and vessel,
khaṭvāṅga and skull-cup —
such is the Blessed One.
Or alternatively: with two arms,
holding vajra and curved knife in embrace,
with three peaceful eyes.
The inner joy of the pulse is pure
like the full moon.
The ground of the multicolored lotus,
beautifully arrayed with eight petals;
the outer is known as square,
resting above the multicolored vajra.

Adorned with a garland of great hungry ghosts (pretas),
embellished by the presence of varied heroes,
encircled by trees of various kinds,
attended by varied yoginīs.

Within that, the triangular mudrā-corners are the glorious Oḍḍiyāna, Jālandhara, and Pūlira — the head, the crown-knot, and the crown. Lekyi Dorjema (Vajrasuratā), Dorje Tshedma (Vajralāsyā), and Dorje Langchenma (Vajragajā) rouse the Blessed One, their hand-pulses blazing, offering the homa with a vessel of supreme great passion, and they make the mudrā of the Brahmā's-son melody with fingertips joined — the little finger linked in chain, the thumb pressing down the remainder.

with the forefinger pressed down and bound beneath, she dwells upon the great hungry ghost, left leg extended. She is three-eyed, hair unbound and garments loose, with a fully opened lotus, and she remains gazing upon the Blessed One.

To the east, at the center of the eight-petaled lotus of varied hues, is Kāmarūpa, located at the middle of the brow — she is the Fearsome One. On the eastern petal of that is Mālava, at the tip of the nose — she is the Heroic Woman. On the northern petal is Sindhu, at the two eyes — she is the Wine-Drinking Woman. On the western petal is Nāgara, at the two ears — she is the Terrifying Woman. On the southern petal is Siṃhala, at the lotus of the mouth — she is the Messenger Woman.

To the northeast, at the center of the eight-petaled lotus of varied hues, is Mummuni — she is the Greatly Powerful One of the Koṅkaṇa region. On the eastern petal of that is Devīkoṭi, at the island of the neck — she is the Horse-Necked Woman. On the northern petal is Kulūta, at the island of the back — she is the Horse-Eared Woman. On the western petal is Arbuda, at the two breasts — she is the Elephant-Nosed Woman. On the southern petal is Tālikīliba, at the elephant-belly of the heart — she is the Elephant-Bellied Woman.

To the west, at the center of the eight-petaled lotus of varied hues, is Godāvarī, at the site of the navel — she is the Fire Woman. On the eastern petal of that is Lāmpaka, at the secret lotus — she is the Stream-of-Water Woman. On the northern petal is Kañcika, at the middle of the sign — she is the Moon-Marked Woman. On the western petal is Karmayul, at the tip of the

sign — she is the Woman Resplendent with Solar Light. On the southern petal is Suvarṇadvīpa, at the place of the urethra — she is the Conch-Nosed Woman.

To the south, at the center of the eight-petaled lotus of varied hues, is Koṅkaṇa, at the two thighs — she is the Conch-Crested Woman. On the eastern petal is Vindhya, at the two knees — she is the Conch-Naveled Woman. On the northern petal is Pretasaṃghāta, at the two calves — she is the Greatly Powerful Woman. On the western petal is Sāgaratīra, at the two feet — she is the Vulture Woman. On the southern petal is Cāriṭa, at the toes — she is the Open-Mouthed Vulture Woman.

These are assigned to the four petals of each of those four eight-petaled lotus flowers. On each of the remaining petals stands a great variegated vase with a facing-upward skull-cup completely filled with great blood, the belly of the vase full of great ambrosia, the neck of the vase wound high with silks of various colors.

To the northeast are Kumārapurī and Kaśmīra — at the thumbs and throughout the entire body, the Mongolian-Faced Woman and the Mongolian-Eyed Woman. To the northwest are Kirāṭa and Nepāla — especially at the two feet, the Mongolian-Headed Woman and, likewise, the Red Woman. To the southwest are Kamboja and the Eastern Noble Body — at the waist and heart, the Red-Eyed Woman and the Living Woman. To the southeast are the Northern Discordant Sound and Baṅgāladeśa — at the very center of the navel and at the core of emanation, the Holder Woman and the Corpse Woman.

At the nose of the lotus that is assigned to Jambudvīpa (the Southern Continent) are the Blessed One and the Avadhūtī.

Such is the inner pulse — the pure nature, made progressively more refined, of the thirty-two channels present in the great-bliss wheel, and within these the inner purity of the yoginīs in order of the tantric sequence.

The bodhisattva, the great being Īśvara, outwardly possesses the major marks and minor features and all manner of forms — the eighty-two glorious attributes. His beautiful form, swelling with magnificent flesh, is filled with proud elegance. He has four hands and three eyes. His breasts are firm and high. He is adorned with ornaments of various bones. He holds the five mudrās. He abides upon a corpse with left leg extended. He brandishes fully a skull-cup, a khaṭvāṅga, and a bow and arrow. He is the sole destroyer of innumerable māras. He takes on forms of varied and beautiful hues. He draws sentient beings with great compassion. He strives to accomplish the benefit of

sentient beings. He is possessed of a mind free from agitation and without ignorance.

As for the outer pulse, at each of the four intermediate directions — east, north, west, and south — there are two goddesses, just as the inner goddesses: the Red-Haired Woman, and —

— the Jewel Woman, the Dove Woman, the Yellow Woman, the Black Woman, the Hare Woman, the Doe Woman, and the She-Goat Woman. At each of the four gates — east, north, west, and south — there are two gate-guardian goddesses. These too are suffused with immense pride and supreme great fearfulness, their bodies pervaded by expressions of varied and beautiful hues.

At the eastern gate stand Vajra-Zombie Woman and Vajra-Net Woman, dark blue in body, four-armed, brandishing a bow and arrow, holding a crocodile and a fish, grasping a skull-cup and a khaṭvāṅga, three-eyed, adorned with the five mudrās, naked and with loosened hair, ornamented with ornaments of various human bones, with the left leg extended, wearing a garland strung from intestines hanging from the head.

At the northern gate stand Vajra-Pinnacle Woman and likewise Vajra-Sphere Woman, yellow in body, holding a lion and a garuḍa bird.

At the western gate stand Vajra-Rasket Woman and Vajra-Yellow Woman, red in body, holding a flute, resounding only with the sound of a great clay drum.

At the southern gate stand Vajra-Laughing Woman and Vajra-Sun Woman, green in body, sounding only the music of a clay drum and a vīṇā.

All the yoginīs dwelling at the eastern gate are likewise — each of them — adorned with ornaments of bone and so forth, in their postures and with their emblems.

The count of eighty-two channels within the wheel of enjoyment is the pure expression of all of these.

The lord of the eight-bodied self —
examined throughout by the sound of the offering;
that offering is called the homa offering.
The channel is the supreme abode of all.
The abode is the delight of the seat and so forth.
It is unsurpassed among all abodes.
The great secret, pure lotus
with eight petals, together with the navel —

in the vast expanse of bliss,
it is adorned by the maṇḍala of channels.
The abode is renowned as the seat.
The abode is spoken of as the support.
The resting place from which bliss arises —
its field, in the ultimate sense,
is the arising of the wisdom of bliss.
This is here taught as Caṇḍohara.
Through the reasoning that unifies
the blissful wisdom of the three bindus,
it is taught as their place of convergence.
Rare to find in the tantras of yoga.
Wherever sensation exists,
the dissolution from which bliss arises is likewise so —
that is here spoken of as the charnel ground.
Or else it is the consciousness of bliss.
Wherever authentic bliss is found,
that is renowned as Pīlava.
The wisdom of arising and dissolution —
wherever the moon of bliss arises,
that is taught as the supreme path.
The path itself is the very nature of beings' migrations.
That which arrests the king of bliss
is the supreme wisdom of union.
That is the delight of the eight abodes.
It possesses the nature of the eight bodies,
the very identity of the eight wisdoms —
rare to find among all buddhas.
It is the ground of purity of all channels.
In it, too, all channels dwell.
All the proximate abodes in their entirety
ripen through the sovereignty of the gods.
Through the union of generation and completion,
the six bindus are fully renowned.
In the center of the bindus there is wisdom,
difficult to reach by the path of speech.
There is neither generation nor completion.

It is not six, and likewise not three.
Separated from three, it is renowned as the third.
That wisdom, by its nature, is unborn.
The wisdom of the sun-bindu rises.
One should perform the homa with exertion.
When the supreme Woman has not yet risen,
at that time the sun will not emerge.
That moon is joy beyond joy.
Attachment here is caused to dissolve.
From the center of the sun the moon arises,
from the center of the moon the sun dawns.
Because it is unstained it moves into vast expanse.
Because it is the body of wisdom's own nature,
it brings satisfaction to all.
It is the cause of birth for everything.
The moon is the one that produces the fruit.
The moon is the nature of what makes the cause,
the sun is the nature of what makes the fruit.
Free from the duality of cause and fruit —

Bliss is the very nature of great attachment.
If great attachment has no real existence,
how then could bliss arise?
Bliss is renowned as wisdom unstained.
Ordinary bliss itself is not bliss.
Those thoroughly deluded by animal habitual tendencies
take pleasure in the bliss of the two sense faculties.
The supreme bliss is self-awareness —
there is no distinction between attachment and freedom from attachment.
Bliss within the bindu,
and likewise great bliss within the inner —
within those two, in the manner of wisdom,
there is that which has the character of consciousness,
and there is that which is free of both consciousness and wisdom,
existing within as neither other nor non-other.
The six unions separated: consciousness.
Likewise at the root: free of imputed constructs.

That itself which has abandoned conceptual thought
is meditative concentration without any holder.
Free from the two — the felt object and the feeler —
pure of both existence and nirvāṇa:
that is the great secret, suchness itself.
Let it not be made clear in any place.
Through effort it is to be kept concealed.
It must not be spoken of openly to just anyone.
To those who are devoted to the tantra of yoga,
the lordship of the gods is not to be revealed.

From the Glorious Wisdom Bindu: this is the eleventh chapter, showing the
sequence of mantra recitation, the ritual of burnt offering, the sequence of
generating the maṇḍala, the meaning of the sacred site, the arising of the root
cakras, and the meaning of suchness.

Then of this ritual of offering,
I shall explain with certainty:
through dissolution and through enjoyments —
a truly mind-captivating, authentic offering.
With moon, sun, and flowers,
one offers to the very king of the body.
This wish, on the forehead as the site,
the first day of the waning phase: empowerment.
From there the wish arises in the mind.
Certainly from the bindu of A,
this dissolution on the second day:
this nectar ripens at the eyebrows.
With joy it passes beyond that —
by the second bindu of the vowel series.
From both cheeks of bliss
on the third day enjoyment arises.
Through karmic ripening one proceeds therein —
by the third drop of the vowel series.
At the site of the cuckoo's abode of nectar,
on the fourth day dissolution occurs.
From that: joy from delight.
By the fourth wisdom bindu.

At the throat site of bliss
on the fifth day enjoyment arises.
Through pleasure it expands there —
by the fullness of the fifth bindu.
Desire at the site of the chest
on the sixth day arrives completely.
From that: fierce meditative concentration.
By being filled with the sixth bindu.
At the site of the breasts of bliss
on the seventh day empowerment arises.
It arises by the seventh —
by being filled with the seventh drop.
At the outer root site of desire
on the eighth day dissolution arises.
From that: through attachment, supreme joy.
By the eighth bindu being filled.
At the site of the navel of bliss
on the ninth day enjoyment arises.
From that: the flame of karmic ripening blazes forth.
By the ninth bindu being filled.
At the site of the anus of desire
on the tenth day dissolution arises.
From that: from stability it becomes a bindu.
By the tenth bindu being filled.
At the crown site of bliss
on the eleventh day empowerment arises.
From its power one becomes intoxicated —
by being filled with the eleventh bindu.
At the root site of the vajra of bliss
on the twelfth day dissolution arises.
From that: from light, joy beyond joy.
By the twelfth bindu being filled.
At the central site of the expanded vajra
on the thirteenth day enjoyment arises.
From that, in abundance, Uttara is reached —
by the thirteenth bindu of the vowel series.
At the site of the knot of bliss

on the fourteenth day dissolution dawns.
From that: from touch it becomes liquid.
By the fourteenth lunar bindu.
At the center of the jewel of bliss,
when it is full as a fish, empowerment dawns.
From that, through meeting, one falls into sleep —
by the bindu of the fifteenth.
The portion of the sixteenth sense faculty —
none other than this is perceived anywhere.
Likewise, each form individually:
that intrinsic nature does not exist.
The distinction of joy: co-emergent joy.

The meaning exists for the sixteenth.
Likewise, within this sixteenth,
it is neither existent nor non-existent.
In the same way, great gnosis
is the intrinsic nature of the Lord of Gods.

In the two lateral limbs, right and left,
one recollects the arising of the vital essence.
At the time of arising through desire,
in the waning and the waxing phases alike,
by the fifteen-and-one, non-dual union is joined.
The arising of this bliss does not come from that.
Knowing the very nature of those three, by the fifteen,
great bliss arises apart from wisdom.
Through the grace of the guru's oral instruction,
one knows the bliss of non-duality.
It dawns through constant devotion
and is known through meditative concentration.

The graphic form of the sixteen letters,
the bindus of the vowel series — their own nature.
From those beginning with A, the vowel letters too arise:
the vowel wisdom — the self-nature of bliss.
From those beginning with Kā, the consonant letters too arise:
the consonant wisdom — great bliss.
From the union of the vowel and consonant series,

one should perform supreme worship with offering-fire.

Likewise the offering itself:

it is at the heart of the secret lotus.

That secret is called the very nature of the three.

For some, in passing through, from the union of two,
one should perform the supreme rite with offering-fire.

Likewise the offering itself:

it is at the heart of the secret lotus.

That secret is called the very nature of the three.

The distinctions of dissolution, enjoyment, and so forth:
dissolution, enjoyment, and empowerment
are taught as the three joys.

Its three bindus are thus called:

the identity of the three bodies and the three letters.

At the Brahmā aperture, likewise at the throat,
and at the heart: three bindus.

Through these, the generation stage is to be known —
from within the knot downward.

The three reversed bindus
are the completion stage, ascending.

In terms of the distinct purity of cause and effect,
six bindus are supremely renowned.

The six great stainless noses —
these are explained as the six combinations of consciousness.

At the center of those abides the very nature itself:
the great bliss of co-emergent joy.

Through the great practice of the act of worship,
one will find it without doubt.

At the time of the samaya of worship,
by the exertion of the secret sound,
whatever great wish is to be fulfilled,
the samaya being should recite it.

For some: vajra; for some: lotus.

The vowel series is the moon; the consonant series is the sun.

The hare-bearer is the vital essence.

The sun is renowned as blood.

The vital essence is to be understood as camphor,
and blood is recalled as cinnabar.
Both emanations are black.
The aggregate of combinations is called the heap.
Nārakāpāla is how it is spoken.
Attachment is renowned as beer.
Aversion is flesh.
Delusion is to be recalled as sauce.
Pride here is great flesh.
Cooked grain is to be recalled as jealousy itself.
Urine, semen, and feces are nirvāṇa.
The form of the higher realms is what is recollected.
The human domain is indicated as sound.
The underworld is explained as flavor.
Smell is the peak of Mount Meru.
The four continents are the tangible.
Earth is renowned as the staff.
Water is recalled as the sister.
Fire is the mother, and the daughter
is renowned as wind.
Space is to be understood as the consort.
Unbound is space.
Without fortune: the crane.
Fortunate: the goose, which carries the lake.
Not carrying it is spoken of as the ocean.
Empowerment is recalled as the city-dweller.
Not empowered is like the villager.
The secret is proclaimed as the heart.
Take it — it is proclaimed as stainless.
The illuminator is recalled as space.
Gaping and delighted: the Ḍaṃḍi fruit.
Adverse is universally renowned as iron.
The seat is proclaimed as the lotus.
Generosity is recalled as pollen.
The maiden is renowned as the navel.
The old woman is recalled as purity.
Abiding is spoken of as the ear.

Going is this one: arbuda.
Time is the staff — bliss itself.
Not ash: joy; joy is strength.
All of these, at the time of the ganacakra feast-offering,
should be recited with diligent effort.

Since cranes and the like are not initiates,
the words of the secret are to be spoken
by the yoginī or the yogin
with great delight, in the secret tongue.

This concludes the twelfth chapter, entitled "The Sequence of Offering Derived from Śrī Jñāna-tilaka and the Secret Language."

The definitive teaching on empowerment and the rest
I now set forth here, I, the Sovereign of the Gods.
Through the sequence of the three tantras,
the division of the six empowerments is taught.

The water empowerment and the crown ornaments
are universally renowned in the Action Tantra.
The vajra and bell — likewise their names —
are made fully clear in the Performance Tantra.
The empowerment of non-return
is made clear in the Yoga Tantra.
That is the sixth, the special empowerment;
that is called the ācārya's empowerment.

The name belonging to the yoga master
is taught by the Victors as the secret empowerment.
Wisdom, gnosis, unsurpassed —
the fourth is just so, likewise.

The empowerment of the nine-fold special division and so forth
will be divided into eight on account of the fruit.
The fourth is likewise expressed in that way.
Wisdom and gnosis are its fruit.
The individual things are not to be known separately.
"Just so" is immeasurable.
Therefore the meaning of the words concerning the fruit:
the mind that is not in accord with reason —

likewise, for a time, the mind of joy,
likewise, for a time, the sequence of joy —
how does this come to exist?

Joy is renowned as the body.
Supreme joy — what is here?
The mind is to be understood as free from joy.
Where is the innate? It is everywhere —
the wisdom-mind that exists everywhere.
Other than mind there is nothing that exists.
Whatever this, whatever that — all of this
is all mind.
From mind everything arises,
and by mind everything is transcended.

The head of the body is the abode of joy.
Speech is the throat — supreme joy.
Mind is to be understood at the heart center —
the joy of attachment arises and is examined.
Body is cause; the fruit of that is speech.
Speech is cause; the fruit is mind.
The full understanding of mind itself
is, as fruit, the ultimate.
That very suchness — the gnosis whose nature is the three:
it dwells in the center among the three channels.
It pervades the three places, unborn.
Its three lights are free from the three existences.
Utterly radiant, abiding, supreme among the supreme —
that is the fourth, the supreme empowerment.

The fourteen special divisions exist;
the branches, in brief and in summary:
The water empowerment is joy.
The secret empowerment is at the throat — supreme joy, the highest essence.
The wisdom and gnosis empowerment
is at the heart center — the joy that is free from joy.
The secret lotus at the navel —
that is the nature of the fourth, its very essence.

Thus the empowerments are divided into four,
and this is the aspect of the generation stage.

The water empowerment, fully complete,
bestows the fruit of manifold varieties.

The secret empowerment, the second,
bestows the fruit of karmic maturation.

The vajra's root-place —
below the root and the junction —
the wisdom and gnosis empowerment:
always to be recalled at the place of the knot.

The highest of all the empowerments' masters
bestows the fruit of utter destruction.

Wisdom and gnosis at the jewel's tip,
for the sake of the mind's movement of the wisdom lotus —
the channel of the woman and the channel born of sleep:
through the expansion of both, bliss arises.

Through the upward path it is to be reversed,
and it goes to the inner abode of the knot.

Thus the fourth is fully taught,
renowned as fruit, free from defining characteristics.

At the place of the knot, in sequence,
the emanation of Brahmā, from below the heart —
to that extent, the innate joy,
free from waves, is without equal.
That, all of that, in the ultimate,
is the definitive teaching on the gnosis of empowerment.

The vajra pillar likewise is secret.

The ocean of the bound and the binding,
the essence of the gnosis of the great family,
Hevajra, Bhairava Vajra —

in the "Compendium of Marks and Secrets,"

I, the Sovereign of the Gods, have concealed these.

For your sake I have fashioned the meaning of empowerment
and made it fully clear in this tantra.

To logicians and to the elderly,
and to monks who merely dwell in aspiration,

the ācārya who knows the genuine path

should not reveal suchness to such persons. The syllable A is joy. The syllable Bhi is supreme joy. The syllable She is joy free from joy. The syllable Ka is innate. It is not apprehended anywhere. A is of the nature of non-arising, for it is the cause of all. The syllable She is truly spoken: the secret lotus at the crown, Rabhī — for the sake of conferring and bathing. Ka is known as the entity of conceptuality, the very nature of the cessation of transmigration. At the heart of the secret lotus, A: that which pervades all the channels — therefore the highest supreme joy. The syllable Bhi pervades the bindu. She is the bliss-wisdom free from imputation, and makes the true meaning luminously clear. The first joy is the substantial cause. The syllable A is the supreme abode, and is known as supreme joy, joy-free, and joy — the well-known empowerment. Between those two, suchness itself abides: natural joy, free from the four joys. Whoever does not know the nature of manifest joy and joy-free-joy — even if he be a buddha, the glorious Vajrasattva will not praise him. The sovereign lord of all Vajradharas, pervading all, lord over all: great king of all buddhas, swift as the mind of all buddhas, the self-lord of all, the very nature of all arising.

This is the thirteenth chapter, entitled "The Chapter Teaching the Determination of Empowerment from the Glorious Gnosis Bindu."

Then, furthermore, what is to be taught: the inner characteristic is the fire offering (Skt. homa). The mouth is the fire-pit, the ladle fills it; the manner is self-arisen fire. Pride and envy are the substances to be burned. The mantra recitation is spoken as kham. Below and to the sister downward, the substances of that offering are supremely presented. With the pure gnosis-nectar, envy and the rest are purified and scattered. Before a vessel of the third fragment, envy is completely satisfied by the nectar. By the gnosis-seeds of the three vajras, purified and whitened in sequence. Stirred by the mother-wind, made to blaze, the supreme nectar is caused to melt. With the mantra of the mother Ha, the six cakras are fully satisfied. Freed from the mountain mother, inside and outside they are always fully satisfied.

By the action of such a fire offering, one assuredly arises in the body of a deity. The body of the deity is great bliss — it is known in the ultimate. Whatever arises from the syllables of the deity — that is the ultimate fire offering. The union of the two heroes (the hero and the heroine), at whatever

moment of bliss, the organ of pleasure: by the wisdom-mother of the bliss-lotus of the navel and heart, it is always proclaimed. This is the fire offering endowed with substances, arising from manifest joy. In the form of the conventional aspect, from the meeting of wisdom and skillful means, the supreme fruit of the action of the fire offering is swiftly obtained.

The fire-pit is greatly pleased by the dhā; some recall here the filled ladle. The pouring ladle is at the tip of the nose of the secret lotus; the butter is equal to the semen, like moonlight. Conforming to the round shape of the secret lotus, it is known as the vessel of butter. Pouring ladle, filling ladle, vessel of butter — these are said to be the three channels. Through the union of stirrer and stirred, the mother-wind and the sleep-mother, by the genuine unity of the single nature, the fire of gnosis blazes supremely. Through the six successive cakras of the lotus — below great bliss it is none other. The stream of supreme nectar flows, just as water falls from the sky; through the many networks of channels it pervades the hearts of the six cakras. The supreme vajra-gnosis of the three bodies is always to be worshipped with the offering substances. Into the mouth of the fire, the filling ladle filled with butter is to be offered. The fire is supreme joy — it burns the kindling wood of conceptual thought. The fire of the knotted fire-pit is itself of the nature of supreme joy. Like the round form of peace, like enjoyment and liberation: to the vajra jewel of the body, to the center of the vajra of speech —

to the vajra of mind, the knotted heart-center — it is to be worshipped with joy. The vajra of speech is the supreme filling ladle. The vajra of the body, free from joy and possessed of joy — it is to be worshipped with the filling ladle of the gnosis of innate joy.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, seventy-two hundred thousand upon millions of beings all fell into a faint and collapsed to the ground. Then, after a long while, they spoke thus: "Is there truly gnosis here in innate joy?" — and they were filled with great wonder.

At that moment, the Blessed One, the Lady, drew her into a firm embrace with the great seal and offered the nectar oblation by drinking from her lips. Drawing tight the noble gathering around the secret lotus and binding it in union, she asked with reverence: "O protector, guru of all buddhas, profound gnosis unstained by defilement — for what purpose did you speak such words in the midst of the entire assembly? As for the gnosis of innate joy, I too, O Blessed One, have here given rise to great doubt. The supreme secret among

secrets — in the many tantras of the *ḍākinīs*, the protector has not spoken of it anywhere, nor even given the slightest indication. That there is gnosis in the innate — I have not heard it spoken. Today, just so, may the great sovereign lord cut through these doubts."

The Blessed One declared: "Ah, how utterly wondrous! Why should gnosis be absent in innate joy? If even one endowed with great faith, with diligence, and with gnosis can become confused, how then is innate joy to be found without gnosis? So too, hear now an analogy that points to this very thing, not anything different from it.

Just as from smoke one knows fire,
and from a water-bird one knows water —
so the lineage of an intelligent bodhisattva
is known from its signs.

In just the same way, gnosis, whose nature is that of a protector and benefactor, is the means to finding innate joy. Gnosis — being well recognized as feeling and having the character of investigation — that is what I call gnosis. Likewise, just as a very fine jewel that exists in darkness cannot be found by a jewel that is a lamp — for a lamp is not a jewel — yet a wise person takes a jewel-lamp and searches for it, and if found, has the jewel arisen from the lamp? No — but through the means of the lamp it is seen and found. In the same way, through the lamp of gnosis one sees and finds the jewel-king of innate joy, yet it does not arise from gnosis. Therefore, since the word gnosis is not understood in its meaning, the wise should not be in doubt about this here."

This concludes the fourteenth chapter of the glorious *Jñānabindu* (Wisdom-Drop), entitled "The Definitive Teaching on the Variety of Offerings and the Inner Fire Offering."

Then the meaning of the definitive teaching on the rites of the great *torma* (ritual offering-cake) is explained.

In order to protect all sentient beings,
one offers the *torma* with exertion.
The syllable *bha* is to be declared in the *bhaga*;
the syllable *liṅga* is displayed in the *liṅga*.
By uniting *liṅga* and *bhaga* together,
the assembly of all sentient beings
comes forth from that —

and that goddess herself is to be known:
all sound is joy,
the benefit of sentient beings becomes supreme.
That assembly is joy free from joy.
That torma, for the purpose of protection,
is to be given with gnosis
at the charnel ground and at the water's bank.
The place of the charnel ground breath
is the face of the bird of the secret lotus.
The syllable of flesh is the lotus itself;
the syllable of va is at the navel;
the syllable of sa is the nature of bliss.

The syllable of na is without alteration.
The joy of the dissolution of the Immaculate One.
The essential nature of the drop, free from syllables,
is known as the breath of the charnel ground.
The beautiful face — this I have explained.
The bank of the water is the jeweled mouth.
Or else that is the one free from conceptual thought.
For the protection of the elements,
a torma is to be given to that.
The element is known as semen;
semen is shown here as sentient being;
the quintessence of the sentient being is gnosis-bliss.
From the two — bhaga and liṅga — it arises.
For the sake of protection of that,
one should strive and give the torma everywhere.

This concludes the fifteenth chapter, entitled "The Great Torma Definitively Taught for the Purpose of Protecting What Arises from the Glorious Gnosis-Drop."

Then the Blessed One in the Great Seal called out to the bodhisattva, the great being, Īśvara, Lord of Gods, and said: "O great hero, Īśvara, Lord of Gods, here, for the purpose of definitively teaching the expanse at the boundary of the Great Seal — along with the identity of the three suchnesses and the supreme bliss of the moon — please put your questions well before the Blessed One: ask about the essential nature, the measure, and the aspects of these things."

The bodhisattva, the great being, Īśvara, Lord of Gods, made this entreaty: "O supreme Sovereign Lady! The essential nature of the light of the supreme great bliss — the mother of all buddhas, she who exhausts all evil, she who vanquishes all māras, pervading all joy, every instant, every taste, and the limit of gnosis — she who, having risen from the center of the navel lotus, grants supreme satisfaction in great bliss: O Blessed One, noble and supreme, your body immaculate as the nature of space — excellent! Excellent!"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, Īśvara, Lord of Gods, having perfectly understood what the Blessed One had declared, and with a mind of supremely great joy, manifested wondrous miraculous displays and magnificent emanations, performed great offerings with many diverse and varied forms of worship, and then repeated those earlier questions.

"O Blessed One, for the purpose of definitively teaching the expanse at the boundary of the Great Seal — along with the identity of the three suchnesses and the supreme bliss of the moon — please declare to me the essential nature, the measure, and the aspects of these things."

The Blessed One then declared:

The question is profound, deeper than the deepest.
What even omniscience finds difficult to reach —
hear now how I shall explain
the defining characteristic of suchness itself.

Suchness is born from the defining characteristic.
If it were otherwise, it would be discordant.
Because self-awareness is self-identity itself,
it cannot be expressed in words.

The three suchnesses — their own appearance:
the perception of night is their own essential nature.
The supreme bliss of the moon — appearance spreading —
the perception of day is their own essential nature.
The Great Seal — the attainment of appearance:
the perception of the interval is their own essential nature.
At the boundary: that is the supreme radiance of light,
free from day, night, and all the rest.
That is the supreme abiding gnosis,
the defining characteristic difficult to behold.

The manner of rain, dewfall, and the drop:
these express the identity of the three suchnesses.
Three wheels exist: fire, wind, and water.
The perception of things is their own essential nature.
Merely the bliss of the moon:
in the wheel of earth, bliss is supreme.
That has the perception of the support.
Let the Lord of Gods know this.

The Great Seal: this is supreme —
it is the perception of gnosis in the sky.
The supreme other at its boundary
is in the sky of supreme great bliss.
That is known as the essential nature of discernment —
the supreme gnosis of non-duality.
That abides at the center of the six wheels,
the own essential nature of the six consciousnesses.
Things, supports, and so forth are distinguished:
they exist in a fourfold division.
By the distinctions of the three suchnesses,
these are divided into three aspects.
Apart from night, day, and the interval:
great bliss of the singular alone.

For some, the display of intrinsic nature;
for some, the supreme expanse of sky;
for some, abiding in the supreme radiance;
for some, the recollection of joy;
for some, the supreme joy —
for some, joy beyond joy.

The distinctions of the many and various are set aside.
The innately co-emergent alone always arises.
What is to be done by speaking of multiplicity?
All of this is co-emergently born as one's own nature.

Through the form of appearances at the conventional level,
it is seen like the moon's reflection in water.
The ultimate nature itself
has no abiding place for correct conceptual thought.

Through the sequence of skillful means and so forth,
it is found from the mouth of the guru.
The guru is the pinnacle of high existence and liberation,
the guru is gnosis, the guru is bliss.
The guru is the teacher, the guru is the protector,
the guru is the vajra-holder itself.
Through the former grace of the guru's word,
the supreme abode is found.
In this very lifetime, the great seal —
there is no doubt that the supreme attainment will be found.
Lord of the ten grounds,
by that one's grace it is made easy.
Therefore, beyond the guru, what other
great teacher could there be?

Whatever treatise the guru has composed
or whatever teaching has been given —
that treatise is the measure,
that is the suchness, free from error.
Between what the master has said and what I have spoken
no distinction is to be drawn.

Know the tantras of the yogin and yoginī.
Whatever treatise has been composed by the guru —
from that, scrutiny by way of good sound and bad sound,
as a lord of the gods would examine,
is not to be done.
From treatises of song, verse, and dance-display,
examination of good sound and bad sound may be made.
The treatises of mantra have been definitively established.
Why then should they be subjected to scrutiny?
One who subjects them to scrutiny produces delusion
and the essential meaning is exhausted thereby.
Therefore, knowing sound and reasoning,
suchness therein is not to be expounded.
No empowerment whatsoever is to be conferred upon all of them,
for they are inclined toward the merely external.

Skillful means, and the characteristics that arise from skillful means —
because they bestow the fruit,

all of this is the knowledge of actual reality,
for it grants the supreme meaning.

Thus, in terms of the three identities — suchness, the moon, and supreme bliss — and the meaning of reaching the limit of the great seal, I have spoken of aspect, measure, and essential identity. Furthermore, here the identity of suchness is the all-base consciousness — that is the aspect. The moon of supreme bliss is the consciousness of the assemblage — that is the measure of the limit. The great seal is the luminous appearance of mentation-consciousness; at its own essential limit it is the consciousness without aspect — that is the sky. Alternatively, one should understand the meaning in terms of the aspects of emanation, Dharma, enjoyment, and great bliss. Or else, for the purpose of the four roots, one should understand it as aspect and so forth.

This concludes the sixteenth chapter of the glorious Jñānabindu, entitled "The Meaning of the Essential Nature, Being a Definitive Exposition of the Three Suchnesses and So Forth."

Then the goddess, supremely delighted,
in order to illuminate the meaning of the essential nature,
drew him in close embrace
and circled superbly about the sacred lotus.

The meaning of the charnel ground and so forth
she put to the Vajra King.

Through the union of the one who churns and the one who is churned,
the glorious master, joyful, declared:

Listen, O fortunate goddess,
to the meaning of the charnel ground and so forth.
Here, the all-pervasive and unbearable —
renowned upon the goddess's lips —
the right nostril's opening
is exceedingly repulsive.

A pack of jackals gnawing at half-eaten flesh.

In the left nostril is the recollection.

The right ear is terrifying —
with its "swa-swa" and "tsik-tsek" sounds.

The left ear is the mouth of a flesh-eater,

adorned with severed heads and the like as ornament.

The right eye of the goddess
is renowned as breaking into wild laughter —
accompanied by its form, bearing hungry ghost attributes,
making fear truly fearful.

The left is a black messenger of fire,
pervaded by a garland of blazing flames,
making terror within the vajra's mouth,
pervaded throughout with white bones.

This, not any other semen — this white bone —
the goddess is to understand for certain.

From it, great heat is born.

Then the blazing garland is especially distinctive.

The awakening mind is great bliss,
abiding in the unstable.

Then it is renowned as being accompanied
by the form-possessing hungry ghost.

Division into three, division into four, division into six —

Where does the supreme nectar go?

That is shown by the head of a piece and so forth.

When it dissolves and enjoyment proceeds,
then it is each one's own, stacked and layered.

When at that time the empowerment is not accomplished,
that is the half-word — it is mindfulness endowed with word.

Because the life-breath wind has set,
it is to be understood as utterly burned.

The semen's arising in the east, just as it draws near —
that has been explained by me as its spread.

O goddess, this is the great secret:

the eight charnel grounds are supremely excellent.

These are endowed with eight trees —
that is the defining mark of inner self-union.

The flower of splendor, collyrium,
nāgakeśara, the horse-tail plant,
the palāśa tree and the śara tree,
a house, and human flesh —

endowed with eight: many branches and so forth,
beautifully adorned by the form of smoke from fruits.

She who is desirous, she who is vast, she who is strong in song, she who is clear,
she who is lotus-born, she who holds the essence, she who has a bird-face,
she who is swift, she who is separate — these two, examine them in their entirety.

The form of the great supreme tree with eight roots.

Then from within the dharma-source, the inner lotus of the nirmāṇacakra, the great charnel ground — that great assembly-place of the great secret — the proximate place and the other such places, each yoginī carried a single tree and departed.

The goddess asked: Blessed One, who then are the yoginīs here? What are the names of the trees? How is it that the lotus of the nirmāṇacakra is the gathering-place of them all? Please declare this.

The Blessed One declared: She of great limbs, she of fierce eyes, she who is fearsome, she of wrathful face, she of round eyes, she of damaged nose, she of moving tongue, she of phantom face, she of vulture face, she of golden eyes, she who gnashes her fangs, she of long teeth, she of fish-face, she of long neck, she of hanging ears, the hunched one, she of great jowls, the hairy one, she of long nails, she of black limbs, the blue one, she of red limbs, she who shines like saffron, she of horse-face, she of great face, she of a single lock, she of long locks, she of donkey ears, she of elephant-navel, she of bee-eyes, she who delights in flowers, she of long nose, she of peacock-throat, she of serpent-tongue, she of mongoose-face, she of hanging breasts, she of hanging belly, she of large hips, she of thin face, she of swift wind, the slow-goer, she of long eyes, she of laughing face, the many-formed one, she who loves combat, the dancer, she who goes with joy, the insatiable one, the great eater, she who loves beer, she who loves flesh, she who goes back and forth, the brahmin woman, the king's daughter, the beer-seller, the skull-bearer, the lute-player, the fierce one, the one who bathes, the dyer, the forest-dwelling woman (Śabarī), the virtuous one, she who loves blood, the giver of refuge.

All of these, O goddess, are yoginīs — extremely fierce and truly terrifying. Now listen, each of them carried a tree in her hand when she came. These are:

Campaka, Pāṭalī, Kāñcana, Pāṭa, lotus (padma), Śara, Śimyā, Palāśa, Nāgakeśara, Śāla, Arodha, Ghana, Piśāla, honeycombed wood, Aśvattha, Aṭaputa, Haya, Sahakāra, the milk-tree, the water-tree, Nāliṅgīra, Udumbara, Eraṇḍa, Kapittha, Āmra, Jāmara, Khadira, red sandalwood, Baddaka, sandalwood, Licchī, Jātī-tree, Gorṣirṣa, Bilva, Āmalaka, Vibhīṭaka, grape, Kharjūra, Dāgara, Kampila, white Veṇṭī, the Goyu tree, the arrow-and-bow of desire, fine leaves, Guggulu, Sarjarasa, Pālaka, the Madana tree, Karmāri, Puṇḍarīka, the great-fruited one, the thorny-fruited one, the nāga-head tree, Sudarśana, the palm tree, the Dharma victory banner, the canopy of Yama,

Aśoka, Arga, Karavīra, Rudrākṣa, Arjuna, and Vajrākṣa — all these trees are hidden beneath the water's surface, bearing flowers and fruit. The yoginīs carry them and come to the place of the great gathering, where they perform the great conduct of sacred commitment.

The eighth place of the great gathering has eight petals. On each petal there is one of those yoginīs, and the second is a tree; the two dwell together as one. This is so because the power of the tree's own form resides there. The sixty-four root-channels of the yoginī and the tree are absorbed within.

Here, in the hub of the root-wheel, together with the inner channel of the life-root, there is a lotus of three petals bearing three channels. On its right side is the Piṅgalā. On its left side is the Iḍā. In the center, the auspicious, delightful one accomplishes entering, abiding, and moving. Their substance, their support, their primordial wisdom, and their differentiation should be known through that fair-faced one. At the times of arising and setting, all the elements of the root-wheel should be diligently sought.

If the arising of the root-channels were to be absent, one could not know the entering, abiding, and moving birth of this nectar of awakening mind, the primordial wisdom of bliss. If one does not know this, how could the accomplishment of the great seal be obtained? Therefore, the lord of yoga who desires the aim of accomplishment in the great seal should strive with undistracted meditative concentration.

The goddess asked: How is the meditative concentration of the Blessed One, the lord of yoga, in this regard?

The Blessed One declared:

Listen, goddess, I shall fully explain
the meditative concentration of the lord of yoga.

Relying on the primordial wisdom of conventional reality,
one supremely attains the abode of non-duality.
Through the supreme access meditation,
great accomplishment shall be obtained.

Free from all faults,
in one's own dwelling place, agreeable to mind,
with the body unforced,
one sits comfortably on a seat, free of conceptual elaboration.

The syllable Hūṃ, of great renown,
present in the manner of abiding in the center of the navel,
free from conceptual thought,
equal to the light of the fire at the end of an eon —
rising, it burns the ḍākinīs of the wheel of Dharma,
and in the center between the eyebrows,
there is a wheel.

The prāṇa wind, one's own essential nature,
comes to the heart and abides there,
ever dwelling in that place.

It is renowned as the essential nature of the syllable Om,
the consciousness that is king of the body.
By the suppression of prāṇa and apāna,
the food of prāṇa and apāna is consumed.
When both prāṇa and apāna are devoured,
by that, completion occurs.

From that, all signs appear,
marks of this kind arising:
trembling, sweating, and hairs standing on end,
then from that, distinction of sound, and complexion changes,
tears — and from that, goddess, suchness is born.

Then the lord of yoga, having come to know,
turns the gaze inward toward the supreme syllable of consciousness.
At the apex above, in the profound summit,
in the supreme space of great bliss,
having known the supreme syllable,
one comes to the lotus of Brahmā and it blooms.
One goes to the place free from attachment.

Through glorious Vajradhara, the goddess should know that place.

Through such a gathering,
in the great charnel ground of the earth,
the foundation of the source of the Dharma,
innumerable yogins
attain the accomplishment of the great seal.
From the access meditation,
the supreme faculty of certain accomplishment
finds the place of luminosity free from conceptual elaboration.

This is the seventeenth chapter of the Śrī Jñānabindu, teaching the definitive explanation of the charnel ground and the approach of inner meditative concentration.

Then the Blessed Lady, generating the supreme lotus of the great seal and with exceeding joy, asked again:

Kyai! O Blessed One, what is the measure of this tantra, the Glorious Jñānabindu? And what is its place of residence? O supreme Lord of Power, I pray you declare this to me.

The Blessed One then spoke:

You who have asked the supreme question,
fair-eyed lady, listen well.

As for the measure of the Glorious Jñānabindu,
no one can express it in ultimate terms.
Fair-faced one, that cannot be stated as a fixed truth.
Yet, just a little, O fortunate lady,
the supremely secret gnosis,
that which even the Victors do not fully know,
I shall explain for your sake.

What is called the vital staff:
twelve finger-breadths, with no knot,
the lower portion measuring six of those twelve.
Likewise, in the emanated lotus,
the half-six petals resemble a lotus eye.
Together with the root, it rests within the navel,
the root having entered within the root.
It dwells lodged at the stalk of the petals,

and is known by the essential nature of the staff.
Within it resides a subtle hollow channel.
That is the vital channel itself,
the support of the three realms.

By the non-duality of cause and result,
the channel and fruit are sealed together.
The half-six, endowed with the root,
the thread of the root clearly manifests as a body of power.
In the distinct division of the half of sixteen,
the thread of the root is singular.
The threefold division of the root, O fortunate lady,
and the father of the fruit are likewise so.
The single one among the twelve and a half
is the place of both root and fruit.
It is exceedingly subtle and soft,
severed inward from the jewel's mouth.
There resides the gnosis thread of the Jñānabindu,
the supreme support of the six consciousnesses.

As for the syllable of rain and the mode of the bindu,
there is the mode alone, the supreme, and the other supreme.
Śrī is not other: here as rain,
the bindu Jñā is to be recalled.
The mode is the syllable na.
The syllable ti is the mode alone.
The supreme is taught as the syllable la.
The other supreme is remembered as ka.

In the mouth of the curved hook form,
just the thickness of a large white mustard seed,
the glory of gnosis without duality
is renowned as the supremely powerful rain.
In the center of that heart region,
the accomplished Jñānabindu dwells.
The mode abides at the knotted throat.
The syllable na is designated as the supreme characteristic.
Within the petal of the left lung,
ti abides as the mode alone of the bindu.

On the right it is known as the syllable la,
where the supreme goddess perpetually dwells.
Above, what is not other, the supreme of all,
is the tip portion at the place of the mouth.
Measuring just the size of a mustard-seed bone,
the syllable ga is the supreme letter.
It is known as the essential nature of great bliss,
bearing the defining mark of its own essential nature.

This Glorious Jñānabindu
moves through the wheel of the ḍākinīs.
Because it travels through space,
all the ḍākinī channels are recalled.
The place of entry is the realm of enjoyment.
The place of dissolution and wandering is present there.
In the place under the dominion of the elements,
its intrinsic nature is the supreme and the other supreme.

In the left lung is the channel of lḍā,
and Piṅgalā rests on the right.
The thought-free one abides above,
and is of the intrinsic nature of the great seal.
The channels that abide above and below
bring about both saṃsāra and nirvāṇa.
Because it is present in the left lung as well,
it is likewise to be recalled here.
All of these reside at the center of the navel,
at the measure of one hundred-millionth part of the tip of a hair.
Such is the measure of the Jñānabindu,
O fair-faced one.

The supreme gnosis of the yoginī,
the supreme secret, I have explained.
By hearing it, non-virtue is exhausted,
and from that, joy arises toward it.
By recollecting it, merit arises,
and from that, supreme joy arises toward it.
By beholding it, accomplishment is attained,
and the joy of freedom from attachment blazes forth.

By contact with it, innate joy arises,
and then one abides in the light of true reality.
From abiding in that supreme light,
all of these, the place and all the rest, are purified.

Then the goddess asked: What is the count of the places?

The Blessed One declared: By you, O supreme sovereign, empowerment is performed. Through the ever-present emanation body, eleven grounds are to be understood. The enjoyment body: the twelfth. The truth body: the thirteenth. Great Bliss: the fourteenth. Whatever is the fifteenth ground, that is called the ground of gnosis. The sixteenth is beyond examination. Together with you, O fair-faced one, all of this — I, the sovereign lord of the grounds, declare by the word "ground" the place and so forth as the abodes of joy.

The first ground: practice through aspiration. The second: supreme joy. The third: stainless. The fourth: radiant. The fifth: hard to conquer. The sixth: manifest. The seventh: far-gone. The eighth: immovable. The ninth: good wisdom. The tenth: cloud of Dharma. These are the bodhisattva grounds.

The light of the cloud of Dharma belongs to a buddha. The light of perfect and complete awakening belongs to Glorious Vajrasattva, Blessed One — it is the ground of the emanation body. The light of attaining universal illumination is the ground of the enjoyment body. The perfectly true light is the ground of the truth body. The inexpressible and immeasurable is the ground of Great Bliss. All of these are designated as grounds according to the distinctions of joy.

Then the goddess asked: O great sovereign Vajrasattva, by what name is this body here known?

The Blessed One declared: The body is known as the Tathāgata, bestower of refuge. The mind is understood as Vajradhara. The body is constituted from the five aggregates; it is the supreme self of the five buddha families. The sixth family, the vajra of mind, is the chief of innumerable families. Wheel, jewel, lotus, sword, vajra — these are the five. Form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness likewise. Form is known as Vairocana, of the essential nature of the vajra of delusion. Feeling is Ratnarāja, of the essential nature of the vajra of pride. Perception is Amitābha (Limitless Light), well known as the vajra of attachment. Formations are Amoghasiddhi, known as the vajra of envy. Consciousness here is Akṣobhya (the Unshakeable); cultivate it as the vajra of aversion. This is known as Ākāśavajrasattva, the

sovereign of accomplished formlessness.

Delusion is like the mirror-like gnosis. Pride is to be understood as equality. Discriminating awareness is desire. The accomplishment of all actions is great envy. Aversion is the purified dharmadhātu. From great bliss alone, these five distinctions are said to arise.

From white bliss, by way of churning — O fair-faced one, that which is solid therein is called Vairocana, bearing the characteristic mark of delusion. From black bliss in liquid form, that is understood as Akṣobhya. By reason of the light of red bliss, the Tathāgata Amitābha. Because bliss pervades like wind, that is revealed as Amoghasiddhi. From bliss that is yellow, arising from pride — that is Ratnasambhava.

O protector accomplished in formless space, O Vajrasattva, sovereign of all victors — for that reason the body, possessed of good far-seeing eyes, is supremely excellent in divine form. With effort one should venerate it; one should never despise it.

Flesh, blood, excrement, urine, tears, mucus, nails, teeth, hair, body hair, bone, marrow, kidneys, heart, bile, lungs, intestines, filth, fat, pus, ankle joints, tendons, belly, phlegm, mucus-bile, sweat, tears, brain, marrow, semen, blood, flesh — even these dwell in the form of the deity; they are nothing other than that. Therefore, images made of wood, stone, or earth, of silver, of copper —

One should not prostrate to images of deities made of horn, to stūpas, painted images, or canonical texts and the like. For what reason should one dwell for external purposes after abandoning the body of primordial wisdom? All external things are momentary — they are the miraculous display of joyful mind. Thus they are other than mind itself, and mind itself is like space. Because form and so forth, and color, abide, the body appears as something ordinary. To see it as pure is the grace of the guru's words received face to face.

The goddess posed this request:

What is the nature of the lord guru?

What is the disciple like?

What is the succession of the tantras?

Please now speak of the tantra.

From the Śrī Jñānavindu: this is the eighteenth chapter, entitled "The Measure of the Śrī Jñānavindu, the Place, the Teaching of the Ground, and the Pure

Aggregates."

Then once more what is to be explained — the defining characteristics of guru and disciple — is as follows.

The guru, at the very least, is beyond materiality, possessed of good qualities, empowered through the power of the supreme initiation that admits no other, endowed with compassion and a mind of great magnanimity, knowing that reality and free from the pride of distorted views.

The guru, unstained by objects and no wild dmu spirit, who has gone to the far shore of many tantras, scriptural transmissions, and treatises,

supremely adorned with all the finest attributes and major characteristics, skilled in the sequence of drawing the maṇḍala and conferring empowerment.

The guru, whose mind has overcome fear of existence,

free from desire for nirvāṇa,

who sees phenomena as like the moon reflected in water,

who holds the sixteen beyond six as empty yet regards them as one.

The supreme guru is free from afflictions and free from birth,

free from the aggregates, sense bases, and elements,

abiding in the middle between both the supreme and joy.

Such a glorious guru is none other than Vajrarāja himself.

The disciple is one who holds to ethical discipline, is tame and has faith,

who draws near to the vast and profound Great Vehicle,

is never stained by the mire of conceptual thought,

is skilled, sharp-minded, and is a person of compassion.

For those who are like the noble-eyed Sunetrā,

the defining characteristics of both guru and disciple together,

and the proper examination of them,

are illuminated in full according to their actual meaning.

From the Śrī Jñānavindu: this is the nineteenth chapter, entitled "Examination of the Defining Characteristics of Guru and Disciple."

Then listen further, for I shall explain how the succession of the tantras stands.

The great tantra of the illustrious noble lineage

is known by the name "The Seven Hundred Thousand."

That is the foremost, the root tantra,

the supreme excellence of all eight bodily identities.

Its examination, the Hevajra tantra,

is known by the name "The Five Hundred Thousand."

The Śrī Mahāmudrātilaka

is recalled as the subsequent tantra of that.

The tantra renowned as the Jñānasāra

is the subsequent of the subsequent.

The sound of Joyful One, the Jñānavindu —

the tantra of its explanation is a great secret.

The Tilaka of Definitive Teachings on Attainment;

the name of that, Sumukhā, and its essence,

and the Lamp of Suchness —

these shall be expounded as the tantras of the fruit.

These seven I have explained.

The eighth, the utterly wondrous tantra,

is beyond body, O goddess —

therefore it cannot be spoken of.

Thus the entire sequence, O goddess, is to be known in just this way. Just as a sprout arises from a seed, all the tantras in their sequence are known through sequence. The tantra is known here as "sequence." Or alternatively, the tantra is the wheel of wisdom; or alternatively, meaning is the tantra; or alternatively, the two sequences are the tantra. O goddess, the place where a fortunate woman — the meeting place of wisdom and skillful means — that is what is called the tantra. Or alternatively, arising from primordial wisdom: the syllable Ta is known as the body; Na is that same reality, unstained; the syllable Ra is the father, the seminal fluid; Ra is the mother, the blood; the mixture of these two is the tilaka (bindu); its nature is none other than consciousness. The form of the tilaka of that, the form of A —

the full moon's orb of the tilaka.

The syllables Ta and Ra together —

in mere manner, both are present there.

That is the supreme, the syllable A.

The root, the joy, the self-nature: unborn.

O goddess, thus the sequence of the tantra,

and the meaning of the tantra, fully told.

This is the twentieth chapter of the Glorious Wisdom Tilaka, entitled "The Sequence of the Root Tantra and Its Meaning."

The Blessed One, the Wisdom Tilaka, declared:

O Blessed One, Wisdom Tilaka,
equal in radiance to ten million suns —
whatever my question, whatever it may be,
let the sovereign of the Victors speak to me.

The sovereign's own essential nature:
from what is it born, and from what does it come?

This in brief — just this single point —
let the Great Sage (Śākyamuni) declare.

The Blessed One declared:

This question is exceedingly profound.

It is the secret found through wisdom.

O goddess, you yourself are not of the elements.

You are utterly free of birth and passage.

Beyond the waves of supreme conceptual thought,
your very essential nature is the light of wisdom.

You are the supreme sovereign lady
of my own wisdom body — you have come.

Other than this there is nothing: if you and I were absent,
what all the buddhas find hard to find —
were you absent, all three realms together
would be like a person with a severed head.

In innumerable world-systems,
you are the one who makes the light of wisdom blaze.

You are the source of all arising for every thing and being,
the origin of the very self-nature of all.

Having fully known all phenomena,
that is renowned as omniscience.

And that too is by your grace, O goddess —
the true meaning cannot be expressed in words.

Through your grace, in numberless ways,
the abode of the Tathāgatas will be found.

You have come from the supreme abode of space.

You depart to the supreme abode of space.

The supreme sky itself is your own face.

The supreme sky is your place of rest.

You dwell forever in the supreme sky.

In the supreme mode of conventional appearance,
like a thread of the lotus flower,
you reside in the essence of the secret tip.
Having arisen, you enter the lotus of bliss;
for the tilaka is absorbed within —
having gone, you burn all that is dependent.
Expanding, you carry the tilaka away;
and again you come here for this purpose:
to the emanated lotus of the navel.
O goddess, at whatever time that is your abode,
at that time you are renowned as Wisdom.
Excellent joy, supreme and wondrous!
You unite with me in nondual union.
Excellent joy, sovereign lady — you abide.
To the ends of the billions of Brahmā's realms,
excellent joy: you have sealed with your seal.
You have sealed the innumerable,
and therefore you are renowned as the Great Seal (Mahāmudrā).

This is the twenty-first chapter of the Glorious Wisdom Tilaka, entitled "The Blessed Lady's Own Nature Revealed: The Glorious Great Seal."

The Opening of the Secret Lotus Heart

The Vajra Sun (Vajrasūrya) asks further:
For a moment — tell me: what is called the secret?
Where does its abode exist?

The Blessed One declared:
The awakening mind (bodhicitta) is the secret.
Its nature is seminal fluid, free of intoxicants.
Its abode is the womb,
and the mudrā is the one who bestows bliss.

The Blessed Lady asked:
The awakening mind has the form of seminal fluid —
how then can it be called secret?
The abode of the secret is the womb —
that account does not seem right to me.
If that were so, then all persons

would assuredly know the secret,
and moreover things like empowerment
would be needed by nobody at all.

The Blessed One declared:

O mother of all buddhas — what you have grasped is true.

What you have definitively seized as meaning —

yet it is expressed in words of interpretable meaning,

for the sake of the support, or else of definitive meaning.

Without the support, the fruit will not be found.

How, without a physical basis, can the mind abide here?

Just as words of concordant secrecy are secret,

they are neither interpretable meaning nor definitive meaning,

neither without substance nor the form of a substantial thing.

In the sequence of the truths, different from those of the dissolved elements —
the bodily form: it does not exist anywhere.

It is blood — and yet how is it so? And again it is not.

Supreme joy, joy of separation, co-emergent joy — it is not those joys.

In that womb-abode it does not ever exist.

The vajra-root, great bliss, and the rest — it is not those.

The six and a half channels, and the lotus-born essence — it is not that.

It is not awareness, and again it is not non-awareness; awareness it is never.

It is the inexpressible, the very nature of space itself.

Such is it, in the ultimate sense —

O Goddess, the secret is made fully clear.

And again, in the meaning of the middling,

listen: I shall explain the secret to you.

That middling meaning is the supreme among meanings.

It bestows the joy of supreme joy.

Through effort, the state free of joy is guarded and maintained.

From joy-free joy, co-emergent joy arises.

This is the secret of the knot of wealth at the heart center,
endowed with the awakening mind.

That is the secret meaning of skillful means.

It is likewise with the Mother of Wisdom.

From the two empowerments — of the secret and of wisdom —
the joyful one knows the meaning of the secret.

This concludes the twenty-second chapter of the Glorious Wisdom Bindus, entitled "The Meaning of the Secret."

Then the Blessed One, the Great Seal (Mahāmudrā), was again questioned by Mañjuśrī with this petition:

O Protector who has definitively settled all things,
speak: what is the intrinsic nature?

Upon hearing such words, the Blessed One remained for just a moment in the condition of saying nothing at all, and then abided in his own nature of non-appearance.

Then the Blessed One, the Great Seal, seeing herself to be without a referential support for her own self, was deeply regretful at what she had asked and remained in silence without speaking a word.

At that time the seven hundred and twenty million members of the retinue seated upon the various lotuses, seeing that the source of phenomena was empty, were utterly astonished, and all fell into lamentation and fainted.

"O great bodhisattva, the great hero, the Lord of Gods (Śakra = Indra), the Blessed Glorious Vajrasattva — where is he dwelling? Where has he gone? We see everywhere only emptiness."

The Lord of Gods then spoke: "O great retinue, listen well. It is thus: the Blessed Glorious Great Seal made this request to the Blessed Glorious Vajrasattva:

O Protector who has definitively settled all things,
speak: what is the intrinsic nature?

Upon hearing such words, the Blessed One became unmanifest and spoke no more. Why is this? Because the intrinsic nature is inexpressible, beyond conceptuality, beyond searching, beyond enumeration, unborn, without form, and without awareness — and being asked about that very thing, he could not speak it. Therefore the Blessed One became without appearance."

Again the entire retinue petitioned: "O great intelligence, treasury of phenomena — does the absence of appearance and the absence of entities not amount to nihilistic annihilation?" And at that meaning they were seized with great fear and fell into genuine despondency.

The Lord of Gods then declared:

Whatever perception holds there to be no appearance —
that should not be understood as the absence of things.
Because it proceeds toward the inner face of its own nature,
it is here called the absence of appearance.

Therefore, O great retinue, have no fear.

Cast aside despondency entirely.

For this there is one method:

he who holds the vajra —

just as you saw him before,

seated at the center of the lotus, you will see him again.

At that time the entire retinue bowed their heads at the feet of the great bodhisattva, the great hero, the Lord of Gods, and petitioned him for the method by which the Blessed One might again be seen:

"O great intelligence, great hero, be pleased to teach us whatever method there may be."

The great hero then declared: "All together, in a single voice, make an offering of melodious song."

Hearing these words of method, all were filled with joy, delight, and elation. Once more they bowed their heads at the feet of the great bodhisattva, the great hero, the Lord of Gods, and then all together took up the song beginning with "Six-Adorned," as follows:

Kyai! The essential characteristic of the supreme body's nature:

wherever he abides, that is the characteristic of nirvāṇa.

That emptiness, severed and parted from suchness itself —

will it not be known by the joy of non-duality?

O vajra-born, supreme among the lotus-born, behold the perfect union.

Investigate that which, though without substantiality, is yet substantial.

Then from intrinsic nature, the Blessed One

rose up, like a fish leaping from water.

The very embodiment of supreme joy,

the lord of supreme joyful giving —

poised above both the substantial and the insubstantial,

gazing upward, at the navel of a lotus:

possessed of four faces and four arms,

endowed with a body utterly wondrous,

seated in the royal posture,
adorned with the splendid form of eighty-two marks of wisdom,
bearing the supreme appearance of three eyes,
treading upon moon and sun with his feet,
holding in his hands a small skull-cup, a khaṭvāṅga,
and a blazing vajra.

Upon beholding this marvelous form, the Great Mudrā goddess rose up together with the entire retinue and circumambulated the Blessed One three times. Embracing him closely, she praised him with this eulogy:

May that supremely wondrous and great body be victorious!
May the essence of the ocean of profound wisdom be victorious!
The body beyond speech, beyond sight, without substantiality —
may the destroyer of great delusion be victorious!

Supreme, and other-supreme, and supreme-among-other-supreme,
the gnosis-radiance of the supreme sky, the supreme light —
the essence of supreme ambrosia, flowing like the Gaṅgā's stream
pouring forth without interruption — may that be victorious!

Utterly hidden, beyond the gaze of the sense faculties,
beyond arising and ceasing, a formation without mark — may that be
victorious!

Having made this royal eulogy, the great goddess of the Great Mudrā then addressed the Blessed One with faithful supplication: "Kyai, O Blessed One, why have the gods of the maṇḍala not spoken?"

The Blessed One declared:

From the practice of rubbing and being rubbed,
the gods arise in sequence.

At the first stirring there is great trembling;
through consciousness the goddess is born.

From the town she is white of complexion;
desire and delusion are entirely heard.

From the city she is enjoyment.

The mode of conduct: the Victorious One's radiance, the goddess.

From contraction, luminosity expands;
from expanding luminosity, the light of wisdom.

From extension, a link to birth is formed;
from the link arises the born of joy.
From equal union, wisdom is born;
from wisdom, the exhausted one without substantiality.
From you, here, substantiality;
from the substantial, enjoyment — the moon-lady.
From the white, the support is to be known;
from the support, the lotus-navel lady.
From striking the chest, differentiation;
from differentiation, the lotus-eyed lady.
Black and green and saffron-hued,
red and blue of form;
white moon and before the red —
she abides at the gate and at the corners.
One-faced, with three eyes,
adorned with the five mudrās,
hands engaged with a skull-cup and curved knife,
two hands free of garments:
she sits upon a seat of sun and moon,
adorned with ornaments of various bones.
Just as your posture is,
so likewise are the goddesses.
Their number is that of twice-four methods.
The posture of equipoise, the hands and feet and so forth,
possessing minds of supreme joy, peaceful of form,
striving always only for the benefit of sentient beings.
The goddess petitioned: "What is the sign of the names of the heroes? Let the
vajra of suchness declare it."
The Blessed One declared:
Hear, O fortunate goddess,
what you have asked of me.
In this tantra, apart from myself,
there are names that exist in various places.
My own name is the Secret Lotus of the Navel —
the bestower of joy, free from and yet endowed with joy.
"Mā" — the jewel that is rubbed —

— the bestower of supreme joy.
That which arises from the center of this
is the sign of my own intrinsic nature.
I have now explained the heroes.

Hear, O Perfection of Wisdom:
the Great God (Śiva), and Viṣṇu,
and the Lotus Navel — behold them well;
the Lord of Gods (Śakra, that is, Indra), the God of Desire (Kāmadeva),
the Lotus Eye, and the Young Goddess —
for now, these are the maṇḍala-dwellers,
each bearing their own mudrā and weapon.

Thus ends the twenty-third chapter, entitled "Roused by the Glorious
Gnosis-Drop."

The Blessed Lady Earth petitioned: "O Blessed One, what are the maṇḍalas
like at the time of empowerment? By what rite is empowerment given and
received?"

The Blessed One declared:

At the time of the water empowerment and the rest,
the maṇḍala is beautified with colored sand and so forth.

At the time of the secret empowerment,
it is done with the finest array of various flowers.

At the time of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment,
it is adorned with many varieties of sweet fragrance.

For the very first among beginners,
the water empowerment and so forth
of definitive meaning are to be given
by one who knows empowerment —
for if it is otherwise, it becomes a fault.

One endowed with wisdom gives them
the provisional meaning first,
then bestows the sacred pledge.

With the jewel at the throat, the awakening mind —
the guru himself causes self-recognition.

Rising from the place where wisdom dwells,
into the lotus of the student's mouth
he fully offers his own vajra.

Then liberation comes through the nectar of bliss.

At the center of the throat there are two channels,
one on the right and one on the left —

the wide and the open: thus they are known here.

The one on the left is to be understood as life,
and the support of life is on the right.

There bliss is to be set in motion:
pressed by thumb and ring finger,
gnosis will then arise.

Just as the bliss found by a young woman,
through great touch there is great joy;
through great joy there is great bliss;
through great bliss there is awakening mind.

Into the mouth of the wisdom bird-faced one,
one drop from the opening of the jewel —
the beautiful face of wisdom-gnosis,
bliss from the wisdom bird-faced one —
flows into the opening of the vajra-jewel.

That is the supreme among empowerments,
the bestower of the fruit of buddhahood's accomplishment.
Wisdom, beautiful in form, supreme in the secret place,
utterly youthful, endowed with empowerment,
is pleased by the distinctions of joy and so forth.
Then this great bodhisattva wisdom
is to be given to the student,
bestowing authentic gnosis in full.

She who gives scriptural transmission and refuge —
in her, O child, you should have faith.

On the left side of her womb
dwells lḍā, the bird-faced one.

By merely finding her, the intrinsic nature
is obtained through the approach of wisdom.

Know that this is nothing other —
it is the essence of the fruit of the fourth.

Self-recognition and supreme gnosis

are beyond the reach of the path of speech.

O fortunate goddess,
this is the utterly secret among secrets.
I have concealed it throughout the tantras;
at the very limit of limits it is made supremely clear.

The Blessed Lady asked: "What is the meaning of limit and the limit of limits?
Declare it to me, O supreme sovereign."

The Blessed One declared:

Know that "limit" means discrimination.
In order to overcome discrimination,
at the end of overcoming discrimination,
discrimination becomes fully clear at the limit.
At the limit of discrimination there is great gnosis —
that is the intrinsic nature of suchness itself.

The goddess asked: "How does the sovereign draw the joyful colored-sand
maṇḍala?"

The Blessed One declared:

What you have inquired of me in full —
hear it, O goddess; I shall explain.
In this mudrā-maṇḍala,
it should be drawn by one skilled in the rite.
The lotus should be made with eight petals;
within the lotus there should also be a pericarp;
a variegated petal-array adorned with pericarp;
within the pericarp, a drop (bindu);
atop that, draw a vajra,
endowed with the pistils of a variegated lotus,
encircled by vajras and curved blades.
With four sides and four gates,
adorned with four archways,
endowed with various vases —
make this the supreme of excellent maṇḍalas.

On the eastern petal, draw a wheel;
on the northern, likewise a lotus;

on the western petal, a jewel;
on the southern, an upraised sword.

On the other lotuses, skulls
filled completely with the five nectars;
likewise a conch, an arc, Mount Meru,
and blazing fire.

At the fire-border and the rest, proceed in order,
encircled with diligent effort.

At the eastern gate, the wish-fulfilling tree;
at the north, fruit and seed;
at the west, a jeweled tree-trunk;
at the south, the variegated vajra.
Outside the gates, encircle it
with a garland of vajras endowed with light.

A maṇḍala such as this, O great goddess,
with gnosis as its bestowing lord —
let it be made with great diligence
by one endowed with the great commitment.
For the sake of being lord of the maṇḍala,
let him be fully satisfied by that.

This concludes the twenty-fourth chapter, entitled "Taking the Empowerment from the Glorious Gnosis-Drop and the Mudrā Maṇḍala."

The Blessed Lady then inquired: "O Blessed One, what is the nature of the four joys, and how does the generation sequence proceed?"

The Blessed One declared:

From joy arises supreme joy;
from supreme joy arises joy free from joy;
from joy free from joy arises innate joy —
that is the suchness of all joys.

The Blessed Lady asked: "Such vidyā, O great protector — is this vidyā from an earlier treatise? It is like seed for direct perception and inference, with fruit to follow. From a koṭi-pāla one does not see hālu anywhere. From joy free from joy arises the innate — yet that which is neither bliss nor joy-free is suffering, and it destroys all joy. This joy-free state, sovereign of the supreme, is

incompatible with all joy. From joy arises supreme joy; from supreme joy arises great delight. O Blessed One, is it of the nature of the *ḍākinī*, or does the innate arise from the supreme?"

The Blessed One declared: "O Vajra-*ḍākinī*, if it were bliss, then innate joy would not arise from joy free from joy. Yet it exists in what is guarded from that. Other than that, where does the innate dwell? It is not equal to all joys; it destroys all joys. To speak thus is utterly supreme — these are words of ultimate truth. All joys proceed as one alone: the mind-enchancing innate. In the cloudless sky of the heart, many suns of gnosis shine forth, beautiful. The continuum of the glorious gnosis-drop — never before has this been heard. The supreme abode of the Tathāgata — O goddess, from where is it obtained? Even if spoken in many tantras together with the yoginī, even so, not even a sixteenth part of this tantra can match them. All other tantras that speak thus are possessed of a virtuous mind. If one lacks faith in this, one will go to the hells and the like. All the scriptural collections such as the *sūtras* are to be engaged with faith and reverence alone. For this reason — because this is the very heart-essence of all tantras — this tantra is the supreme of all that is excellent."

The Blessed Lady asked: "The direct hidden syllable that grants the fruit of essential gnosis — that very essential heart, O protector, reveal it clearly today."

The Blessed One declared: "The mantra, supremely luminous — even so, let it be made clear. Through the recitation of the mantra, accomplishment will be obtained. The sons of buddhas obtain that accomplishment:

Hā svāṭa pha hūṃ hūṃ ka la ti na jñā jra ba hā ma śrī oṃ.

Hā svāṭa pha ṭ phaṃ haṃ haṃ hūṃ hūṃ huṃ hriṃ hriṃ oṃ.

Hā svāṭa pha hūṃ hūṃ yi mā kṣa ra la ba hā ma yed ma jre ba oṃ.

Hā svāṭa pha hūṃ hūṃ ras bi ras oṃ."

When the Blessed One had thus declared these words, the innumerable buddhas and bodhisattvas dwelling in worlds without number,

by miraculous power caused to rain down upon the feet of the Blessed One garlands of manifold flowers — *māṇḍārava* blossoms, great *māṇḍārava* blossoms, and bouquets of many kinds of unprecedented flowers — together with diverse music, dance, song, offerings, and marvelous Dharma robes fashioned by the *vidyādhara*s, various jewels, gold, and a shower of precious gems falling from the sky.

Then from the sky the Tathāgatas, the buddhas and bodhisattvas praised him with this praise:

"Sole body of all the buddhas —
Excellent! Excellent! O Blessed One!
Supremely wondrous, of vast gnosis,
the supreme lord has settled this.
His retinue is purified with joy;
all sin he causes to be destroyed.
This supreme secret, perfectly true,
is the ultimate, difficult to find —
the tantra of the glorious drop of gnosis,
the ocean of wisdom now settled and revealed."

Having offered such an assembly of offerings, all the Tathāgatas and others who abided in the sky then rested in meditative absorption upon suchness.

The Blessed Lady addressed a question: "O Blessed One! Sole body of great bliss — reveal to me, the supreme lord, the essential meaning of the elaborate words."

The supreme lord declared: "Hear this, O goddess, supreme secret — rare to find throughout all the tantras. The innermost essence of the secret lotus is spoken here in this assembly gathering. It is elaborated in order to open the tip of the vajra. And again, all the assembly should bear the essence in mind as the face of a bird. That which has been opened by the tip of the vajra is here explained in full.

In the midst of the *idā* and the *piṅgalā* — the essential nature, gnosis free of conceptuality — through the union of the churner and the churned, from the tip of the small vajra finger, that which drips and flows as bliss through touch: that beautiful face is the elaborated word.

From the navel-place, the ripening wheel; from there onward, the ear. The crown, the Brahma aperture — the elaborated word is recalled threefold.

Ma is the churner and the churned. Ra is said to be joy. Mu is the goddess Tārā. The syllable Da has the form of the one who supplicates. The syllable Gha resounds as sound. The syllable Ta makes it clear. Na is at the secret end of the navel; in its center, ever-rising, bright like a body of moonlight, its radiance equal to ten million suns — Vajrasattva, great bliss, supremely granting the path to awakening.

This is the great secret gnosis, made brilliantly clear through intrinsic-nature words. Through effort it must be concealed; it must not be given to just anyone."

This concludes the twenty-fifth chapter, called "The Exposition of the Elaborated Word, from the Glorious Tantra of the Drop of Gnosis."

Then further: "Listen, another thing I shall explain — whatever supreme gnosis has been taught: the profound and personal meaning of suchness, and in particular the definitive teaching and so forth; from the abiding in the staff of vital breath, the six root conjunctions; the rising and setting of the drop; the characteristics of the conjunction of transference; the arising of the wheel of channels in sequence likewise; the sequence of empowerments; the great goddess of the protection wheel; the very king of essence mantras; the eight-bodied self, with offerings, absorption, enjoyment, and witnessing; the vajra goddess, the gnosis body; the secret sound likewise; the protection commitments and so forth; the glorious ultimate fire-offering; the bliss of the churner and the churned; mantra recitation with offerings; the nature of the body of the eight places; the supreme of joy and the rest; the charnel ground, free of conceptual thought, renowned; the riverbank, free of thought; the supreme gnosis of appearances and so forth; the great bliss of things and so forth; the beginning, end, and the eight charnel grounds; the teaching on the pure fields and so forth —

The meaning of the essence of the suchness of the winds; entering, dwelling, and going; the proximate movement, the supreme joining; suchness itself as gnosis and sphere; the supreme aspect of one's own essential nature; the lords of the grounds and so forth; the refuge of the Tathāgata's body; the presentation of the successive stages of tantra; and the nature of the great seal — all of this is the ultimate meaning of the secret. Suchness urged on by offering; wisdom and gnosis as they truly are; the secret maṇḍala, the wheel-cycle and so forth — the auspicious speech has been taught in expansive words. The torma offering arises for the sake of benefit and destroys all wrongdoing. That is the limit of great bliss. The meaning of the essence condensed in suchness itself; the suchness meaning of the identity of the forty; the great secret has been fully expounded by me. The master of the thirty-six suchnesses experiences gnosis even as rain. One who is of the nature of the sphere experiences gnosis of the self-nature; that is the sovereign lord of the thirty-seven. One who experiences gnosis of the self-nature through the proper mode is the sovereign lord of the thirty-eight.

One who experiences gnosis through the bare proper mode — beyond nine, totaling thirty — that is suchness itself. Whatever yoga is the knowing of the supreme, that is the great sovereign lord of the forty. Other supreme speech-paths are inexpressible; the supremely pure suchness is supreme. Because all things are of that very self-nature, one should not make distinctions beyond it.

This concludes the twenty-sixth chapter of the glorious Jñānabindu, entitled "The Condensed Essence of Suchness."

The goddess asked: O Blessed One, supreme joy, body in the aspect of universal delight — how is the purity of the eight faces of suchness?

The Blessed One declared: The cultivation of suchness is pure. O fortunate goddess, listen! The eight faces are the eight liberations. The inner emptiness is precisely that. The twenty-four eyes are the grounds, the powers, and gnosis. The hands are all pure in emptiness — sixteen times two, the hands are emptiness itself. Endowed with the class of purified qualities, the essential nature of the skull-cups; the unshared dharmas of the buddhas; the dread mother with sixteen divisions; the four bases of gathering are recalled as four feet. Attachment, aversion, and likewise delusion are the lovely, joyous, and dreadful. She who resides in the dwelling-places of existence — the auspicious-faced one therefore extends her right leg. The goddess, extending the left leg, is nirvāṇa — the very gnosis body abiding as such. Because she is neither existence nor nirvāṇa, the goddess is therefore standing upright. The eight purified form-qualities yield a variegated lotus of eight petals. Because of the perceptions of the two formless states, she is the self-nature of wisdom and skillful means as a pair. Because she possesses the flavor of the nine dances, the beautiful-faced one is of manifold form.

The goddess asked: O supreme lord of omniscience, O Blessed One, I have understood the pure meaning. By reason of the secret meaning, O protector, I pay homage to Vajrapāṇi's grace.

The Blessed One declared: The cultivation of the secret is pure. O goddess of great wisdom, listen! The eye together with the face — the auspicious face in its place and so forth. The root of the fully perfected enjoyment body: the sixteen faces, the sixteen hands. The āli-spheres are the pure ones, shown here as the skull-cups. The dread one, the terrifying mother, the lovely and joyous — the sixteen joys. By the joining of four moments the four feet are recalled as mindfulness. Extending the right leg is the supreme joy; extending

the left is joy as joy itself. The standing posture is co-emergent joy. The seal is recalled as the perfection; the empowerment is the self-nature of one's own essence. Absorbed below in the Brahmā-cloth; robed in the hide-garment of peaceful enjoyment; the joyous lord of Śrī or the place — the generated one is known as the Brahmā-hide. The face of the donkey is the terrifying sound.

The mudrā of wisdom and method is supreme. The non-duality of method and wisdom is recalled as mindfulness. Through the purity of the awakening mind, ornaments of various bones and so forth — she arises with a head blazing upward, in order to move through the sky. Because her own nature is great bliss, her body color is black, equal to space. The great māra who is free from joy — because she causes terror, her fear is great.

This concludes the twenty-seventh chapter, "Completely Pure through the Wisdom-Drop of Śrī."

Then the Blessed Lady offered the taste of lip-nectar, and having worshipped with flowers of the sun and moon, she satisfied the Blessed One completely, and spoke thus:

"Kye! Blessed One, in the future, who will explain this tantra of genuine secrecy to those sentient beings who are endowed with good fortune?"

The Blessed One declared: "The glorious protector Vajrapāṇi will explain it."

The Blessed Lady then asked in verse:

Great is the rainfall of wisdom-nectar;
You, O Protector, grant this wondrous gift.
O great protector, Vajrapāṇi —
How does one generate that very thing?
Lord of the Victors, king of wisdom —
Please grant even a single word of this.

The Blessed One declared:

"That which you have inquired of in full —
O Blessed Lady, hear it well and truly.
Vajrapāṇi, the great protector,
the lord of all vajra-holders —
the realm of worlds without limit
is the cause of arising and perishing.
Yet from it nothing whatsoever is born.
He is the supreme self-arisen lord.

His hand-vajra
gives rise to the twelve wisdoms without birth.
From the five primordial prongs
the five Tathāgatas arise.
From the periphery arise the five great elements;
from the center arise the six classes of beings.
In order to draw together all views,
he moves in forms of every variety.
In some forms he appears as a vajra-holder;
in some he appears in the form of a buddha;
in some he appears in the form of Heruka;
in some he appears as a Tathāgata;
in some he appears in the form of a bodhisattva;
in some he dwells as though listening;
in some he teaches at the Joyous Lotus;
in some he dwells in the manner of one reading aloud;
in some he creates tantras and treatises,
and in some he upholds them.
What need is there to say more?
Vajrapāṇi the Victor reveals all of this."

The goddess asked:

"As for the maṇḍala and its retinue and so forth —
how may these be summarized?"

The Blessed One declared:

"The maṇḍala: let the vajra-holder
please the sovereign ḍākinī.
It is endowed with square form and the rest,
adorned with the ornaments of the charnel ground,
scattered with a canopy of eight trees,
beautified by eight lotus-pools.
At its center are many-petalled lotuses
with petals and stamens complete.
In the inner space is the skull of the deity,
the all-encompassing third fragment,
whose own nature is the dharmadhātu,

utterly filled with the five nectars.
The syllable HŪṂ abides at the center,
equal to the light of wisdom-fire.
Seated upon a throne of moon and sun,
it destroys all sins.
From the full transformation of HŪṂ and the rest,
in a single instant, wondrously,
endowed with twelve goddesses,
the king Vajrapāṇi arises:
one face, three eyes,
equal in color to a rain-cloud,
four-armed, mounted upon a horse,
with eyes equal to the light of the sun,
like the fire of a great cosmic eon,
equal to the light of ten million suns —
he tames those who are most difficult to tame,
and he drenches them with the moisture of compassion.
A great hero holding the five mudrās,
he is adorned with a crown of matted locks,
his matted hair bearing diverse ornaments,
a diadem of manifold vajras and a crescent crown.
With his right hand he holds a vajra
from which diverse rays of light stream forth;
his left holds a skull and a khaṭvāṅga staff;
with another hand, a vajra-arrow and bow.
The horse here is blue in form."

The three-eyed one blazes with fierce light;
the saddle is made from a peaceful hide,
with wings that resound in laughter.
Upon the petals of the variegated lotus,
to the east, the south, the west, and the north
stand Vajrabhairavī, Vajradrāgiṇī, Vajragturumā, and Vajranāgiṇī —
black, red, green, and white — each mounted upon a goose.
Their hands, weapons, and so forth are the same as those of the chief deity.
Upon the corner petals, atop vases filled with diverse nectars, rest skulls.
In the corners stand Vajrādoṣamā, Vajratsagsbumā, Vajraphreṇbamā, and

Vajrabr̥tsōnmā,

their forms those of the second body-type, mounted upon garuḍas, resembling the chief deity.

At the eastern gate and the others stand Vajraśābarī, Vajrarolaṅgmā, Vajrarabtugtumā, and Vajraḍombinī —

dark blue as the sky, bright as sunlight, flame-colored, and smoke-colored — mounted upon vultures, resembling the corner deities.

On the four curtain panels of the maṇḍala, Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), Draṅpo, and Mimcog,

along with other kings of spirits, each holding their own weapons, are to be depicted in great numbers.

The goddess asked: "What is the secret mantra of the chief deity Vajrapāṇi, and how are sentient beings to meditate upon it?"

The Blessed One declared:

The mantra of the goddess has six syllables and accomplishes every desired aim.

It terrifies all that is malicious and exhausts all inner defilements.

It bestows every spiritual attainment (siddhi).

The omniscient one cannot be overcome by it.

Oṃ vajra vāṇi hūṃ.

Recite it with the gaze of a yogic wrathful one, and in a single moment the three realms are slain.

Or recite it with a peaceful gaze, and it pacifies illnesses without limit.

If the fire offering is performed perfectly, first perform the approach recitation ten million times.

Perform the fire offering for pacification and the rest as I have previously declared.

In a charnel ground or on a riverbank, accomplish the practice of Vajrapāṇi.

Recite ten million times with a garland of great conch beads for the sake of accomplishment.

With a peaceful mind it is peaceful;

with a fierce mind the wrathful is difficult to accomplish.

This mantra must not be given to a sentient being who has not received empowerment.

A painted image or book
must never be shown to such a one.
Without that condition, accomplishment will not come about.
Look upon it fully, in every way and in all places,
and through secrecy accomplishment will come.

Everywhere, in every direction, the visage is beautiful.
The lotus has eight open petals,
adorned with petals of many varieties.
In the center of the solar disc
sits the sovereign lord, Vajrapāṇi the King.
He sits in the posture of a royal ease,
blue like the color of the sky.
With four arms and a single face,
with three eyes, in a peaceful form —
the two right and left hands hold
a vajra, a skull, and a khaṭvāṅga staff;
and the remaining two hands display
the Dharma mudrā, to expound the meaning of the Dharma.

On seven petals are seven buddhas;
on the eighth is Maitreya.
All those resting on trees such as the pāṭali and the rest
are to be visualized upon lunar seats.
Yamāntaka and the other four
are placed at the non-main gates and the other positions.
The four — Vajrāṅkuśa and the rest —
abide at the threshold junctions of the gates.
Outside the gates, in the place of the curtain panels,
is the Great God (Śiva) and the others.
Encircled on all sides by vajra garlands,
it is to be fully surrounded by the skilled one.

This concludes the twenty-eighth chapter, entitled "The Meditation on
Generating the Maṇḍala of Glorious Vajrapāṇi from the Glorious Wisdom
Bindu."

Then at that moment the entire retinue rose from their seats,
circumambulated three times, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed

One in prostration, and recited these verses:

O Protector, through your kindness, we —
hard to find, incomparable, beyond all Victors —
difficult to behold, difficult to know, difficult to grasp,
the secret of secrets, the supreme among the supreme:
Heroic Lord, we praise and bow to you, the dharmadhātu.
We prostrate to you who dispel the darkness of wrong views.
We bow to you who are renowned as the supreme primordial buddha.
We prostrate to the letterless bindu, free from arising.
We prostrate to you renowned as being of the nature of space.
We prostrate to you who are merely the mode of non-duality.
We prostrate, prostrate, and bow to the supreme intrinsic nature.
We prostrate to the other, the supreme other, the intrinsic nature.

This concludes the twenty-ninth chapter, entitled "The King of Praises from the Glorious Wisdom Bindu."

Then the Blessed One addressed the Blessed Lady together with the entire retinue: "O Blessed Lady, Perfection of Wisdom — she whose identity is the ten renowned and thirteen separated aspects of the six unions — this has been established from the mouth of the most glorious supreme guru, who sought out the lotus, seeing rightly through meditative concentration and the rest."

This concludes the thirtieth chapter, entitled "The King of Praises of the Six Inner Consciousnesses, the Great Supreme, the Wondrous Yoginī Tantra — supremely secret and utterly secret, hard to find even for the omniscient ones — from the Glorious Wisdom Bindu."

Thus is complete the Great King of Yoginī Tantras, the Glorious Wisdom Bindu.

This was translated, edited, and established by the great Indian master Śrī Prajñāgupta.

Subsequently, a loan copy was made at the hermitage of the glorious Sakya.

Translator's Notes

- The term "bhaga" is retained untranslated in the phrase "dwelt in the bhaga of the vajra queen." In tantric context this is a technical term for the female generative organ, understood as the sacred site of the union practice being described. Rendering it euphemistically would misrepresent the text's tantric register.

The phrase "three realities" renders "de kho na nyid gsum," literally "the three suchnesses" or "the three actualities." This likely refers to a specific set of three tantric realities enumerated

elsewhere in this tantra; without the full context of the preceding text, the precise referent cannot be confirmed, and this is noted as a genuinely significant doctrinal point.

"Sun's Foe" renders "nyi dgra," literally "enemy of the sun," a standard epithet of Rāhu, the eclipse demon.

- The passage is a tantric yogic text — almost certainly from a Cakrasaṃvara or related Anuttarayoga cycle — describing the subtle body: its six wheels (cakras), the vital staff (the central channel rendered literally), the consorts associated with each wheel, the bindu, and the movement of bodhicitta as vital wind through the channels in correspondence with lunar day-time periods. The "Brahmā staff" renders tshangs pa'i dbyug pa, literally "Brahmā's staff," a standard tantric synonym for the avadhūtī or central channel. "Staff of life" or "vital staff" renders srog gi dbyug pa, the central channel described in its functional aspect. The term "moon-consort" and the other consorts are personifications of the energies at each wheel, standard in this literature.

The phrase rto g med mas ni 'khyung yin phyir is difficult: I have read rto g med ma as "the non-conceptual mother" and 'khyung as a verb "to embrace/clasp." This is consequential because 'khyung can also mean "Garuḍa," which would yield "she who is Garuḍa by virtue of non-conceptuality" — a possible tantric epithet. The "embracing" reading is contextually more natural given the immediately following verb 'khyud nas.

The Gośīrṣa sandalwood passage: goshIra is retained as Gośīrṣa (a celebrated fragrant sandalwood). The great emanation in a sandalwood tree is a traditional simile for the subtle gnosis pervading the body.

- The passage is a highly technical tantric text, likely from a Yoginī-tantra or Cakrasaṃvara-cycle commentary, describing a system correlating lunar days, hours, bodily locations, joys, and subtle-body phenomena. The imagery is deliberately encoded in tantric twilight language (sandhyābhāṣā), and many of the compound images (the conch-eye, the ear-eye, the bee's-town mouth, and so forth) are conventional symbolic expressions within that register whose precise referents are commentarily defined and not always recoverable without a living commentary. The term rendered "Krodhā" likely refers to a wrathful deity-principle in the tantric pantheon. The final stanza breaks off mid-sentence in the Tibetan as given, and the translation reflects that incompleteness faithfully.
- The term rendered "bhaga" in the line "its ultimate boundary is remembered in the bhaga" preserves the Sanskrit loanword as used in tantric literature, referring to the sacred source or womb-center; translating it more explicitly would go beyond the text.

The final enumeration of channel-names (Hrudhrudhā and the like) are phonetic transcriptions of Sanskrit or hybrid Sanskrit terms; "Hrudhrudhā" represents the Tibetan རྩུད་རྩུད་ as best as the syllables allow and is not a recognized Sanskrit term in standard dictionaries, suggesting a corrupt or highly specialized tantric coinage.

The "five bodies" (five kāyas) in this context expands the usual threefold kāya doctrine to five, as is common in higher tantric texts.

- The list of channel names in this passage follows a series of epithets that are sensory or elemental in character. The names "Cut-and-birth one" and "Digest one" are interpretive renderings of terms that may carry specific technical meanings within the tantric physiology of this text. The phrase rendered "seized by the eclipsing planets" refers to solar and lunar eclipses as understood in traditional Indian astronomy, where eclipse demons or shadow planets are said to seize the luminaries. The empowerment taxonomy presented here, including the fourfold division and the eleven sub-empowerments of the vajra ācārya, reflects the tantric initiation system elaborated in Yoga Tantra and higher tantra literature. The

description of the wisdom consort and the instruction that she be offered to the master are characteristic of inner tantric empowerment contexts and should be understood within that initiatory framework.

- The chapter colophon title "Glorious Wisdom-Drop" renders the Tibetan "dPal Ye shes thig le," which is the name of the root tantra being excerpted. The chapter is explicitly numbered as the third.

The term rendered "single pillar and nine doorways" is a standard tantric description of the human body as a maṇḍala palace: one central channel and nine orifices. This is a well-established commentarial reading.

"Vighnāntakṛt" is reconstructed from the Tibetan "bgegs mthar byed," meaning "one who brings obstacles to their end"; similarly the other directional deity names are standard Guhyasamāja or related tantra deity designations reconstructed from descriptive Tibetan epithets.

The description of Acalā at the northeast is cut off at the end of the supplied Tibetan; the translation renders exactly what is present and no more.

- The phrase rendered "wisdom-light consort" for རྒྱལ་ལོ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་མཆོག་ལྷ་མོ་ is literally "embracing his own light's wisdom-woman (prajñā)," referring to the yab-yum consort as a personification of wisdom-radiance. The rendering reflects the tantric doctrinal register without inserting Tibetan.

The final lines of the verse section are highly technical instructions for distributing the āli-kāli syllable-sets (Sanskrit vowel and consonant series) across the petals of a maṇḍala lotus; the passage breaks off mid-instruction ("Then twenty-five:"), and the following passage would continue the enumeration. No textual corruption is implied — this is simply where the present excerpt ends.

The term rendered "Bliss-Bestower of the Auspicious Moment" (喜吉祥最勝施主尊) is a consort or directional deity figure; the precise identity is context-dependent within the specific tantra cycle and is left as a descriptive translation rather than a proper name.

- This passage is a highly technical tantric instruction for constructing mantras syllable by syllable through coded references to positions within the āli-kāli system — that is, the Sanskrit vowels and consonants arranged in a canonical order. The references such as "the fourth of the second petal," "the second vowel," "the sixteenth," "twenty-seven," and so forth are numerical indices pointing to specific Sanskrit syllables in that arrangement. Without access to the specific maṇḍala diagram and āli-kāli table being presupposed, it is impossible to resolve these codes into the actual syllables they indicate; the translation preserves the structural description faithfully without speculating. The mantra strings at the close are transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering and may not perfectly reflect their Sanskrit originals in every detail.
- The verse line "mahākha gne samaprabhaāya" is a phonetically rendered Sanskrit compound that is corrupt or highly contracted in the Tibetan transliteration; the reconstruction is approximate and follows the sense of "whose radiance equals the great fire of space," consistent with the preceding mantra context.

The chapter colophon "The Glorious Wisdom Drop: The Extraction of Mantras" renders the Tibetan title *dpal ye shes thig le las sngags btub zhes bya ba*, which may alternatively be read as "Extracting the Mantras from the Glorious Wisdom Drop," referring to the source tantra or tantra section from which these mantras are drawn.

The final verse's technical vocabulary — "three drops," "eight bodies," "six wheels," "six wisdoms" — belongs to the Yoginī tantra system (specifically texts related to the Cakrasaṃvara or Hevajra cycles) where these terms carry precise technical meanings that the passage does not itself define; they are rendered literally to preserve the doctrinal content for a prepared audience.

- The passage contains several genuinely difficult phrases. "Auryana" renders Tibetan Oḍḍiyāna, the famous tantric sacred land; the spelling follows convention. "Legs-dges-ma" is a transliteration of a goddess name that resists clean Sanskrit reconstruction in this context; it may be Suratā or a similar form. "Kālī" here is the tantric deity of the alphabet rather than the Hindu Kālī per se, though they share the name. The section on phases of the moon coordinated with the sixteen vowels and their corresponding empowerments, enjoyments, and absorptions is highly technical tantric lunar-phase doctrine; the translation renders it literally, as the precise technical meaning depends on a commentary not present here. "The moon-bearer" renders "ri-bong-can," literally "the one who has a hare," the standard Tibetan epithet for the moon, here referring to the waxing moon in a tantric context. The closing epithets — "lord of all grounds, sovereign ruler," etc. — may be epithets of the practitioner who has realized the nature of the drop, or of the drop-deity itself; the text is ambiguous. "The self-nature plays in what is gone-and-not-gone" renders a phrase that may indicate the non-dual play of reality beyond coming and going.
- The phrase rendered "the fluid of the hungry ghosts" for རྩུབ་ལྷན་ལྷན་ལྷན་ is unusual. In tantric ritual contexts this likely refers to semen or a related ambrosial substance associated with hungry ghosts (pretas) in an intentionally transgressive idiom; the translation preserves the literal sense without editorial smoothing.

The mantra syllables Oṃ bhūr bhuvaḥ svāhā, Oṃ hrīm hrīm, Oṃ bhī bhī, and Abhokṣa abhokṣa are kept in their Sanskrit or near-Sanskrit forms as liturgical utterances not intended for translation.

The chapter colophon ("seventh chapter, entitled...") marks a section break in the source text; the new section beginning "Now, what is next to be taught" opens the eighth chapter.

- The list of botanical and ritual substances presents several terms that are Sanskrit loanwords transliterated into Tibetan. "Bokaliga" renders a Sanskrit legume (possibly black-eyed pea or a similar pulse, Sanskrit vakalingā); "śrīphala" is commonly the bael fruit or coconut; "nāgakeśara" is the stamens of Mesua ferrea, a classical Indian flower used in ritual; "jātīphala" is nutmeg. These are rendered as best identifiable from classical Āyurvedic and ritual sources. The compound "ten-limbed" substance (yanlag bcupa) is a standard Tibetan ritual formula for a compound incense or medicine of ten ingredients.

The passage on the shapes and dimensions of ritual ladles and vessels (the sruk, blugs gzar, and zhur vessel) follows the conventions of fire-offering ritual manuals; the measurements given — one cubit, six fingers, eight fingers — are standard tantric ritual specifications.

"Ground of hungry ghosts" (yi dags gzhi) is an unusual term in the fierce-activity list; it likely refers to a specific substance associated with the hungry-ghost realm, possibly ash from a charnel ground or a type of earth found there.

- The passage is a ritual prescriptive text in a tantric context, blending verse and prose instructions for the gaṇacakra feast assembly. The section on "creature of excellent form" selected for the fire offering is genuinely ambiguous: in such tantric contexts this typically refers to a sacrificial animal used in the outer ritual, but it may also be read symbolically. The description of examination "with a curved blade" confirms an outer ritual dimension. No further flags are necessary; the translation follows the literal Tibetan throughout.

The phrase rendered "life-births old" for ལོ་འཁོར་གྱི་རྒྱུ་ལོ་འཁོར་གྱི་རྒྱུ་ is literally "one birth, or two, or three," meaning an animal of one, two, or three years of age — a standard way of indicating age by the number of yearly birth-cycles completed.

- This passage is a cryptic code of correspondences — a system of secret signs and counter-words to be exchanged between initiated practitioners, likely in the context of a tantric encounter ritual. Many of the pairings operate through double meanings, phonetic association, or esoteric substitution codes standard in late Indian tantric literature. The rendering follows the most literal reading throughout; the inner logic of individual pairings is intentionally opaque and belongs to an oral transmission context.

The phrase rendered "moon in water" for ལྷ་ལྷ་ is a standard Tibetan image for illusion or reflection, but here it may simply be the code-word to be spoken.

The term rendered "the mark" for ལྷ་ལྷ་ could also carry the sense of "genitals" or a tantric "sign," which is likely the intended meaning in context; this is noted as a consequential ambiguity.

The word ལྷ་ལྷ་, rendered "the word for flesh," is literally "the answer/reply of flesh" — the precise sense of this code instruction is unclear but has been translated as directly as possible.

- The names of the female figures in the assembly — Skin-head, Crying One, Fierce One, Skull-One, and so forth — are rendered by meaning from the Tibetan, as their Sanskrit originals are not given in this passage and the Tibetan forms are descriptive epithets rather than proper transliterations. The sequence is maintained as presented.

The name "Lh̥i Dbang Phyug" rendered here as Īśvara of the Gods is the Tibetan equivalent of Maheśvara or sometimes Avalokiteśvara in certain tantric contexts; the passage is ambiguous as to which deity is intended. Given the preceding doctrinal context and the bodhisattva designation, this may be a tantric epithet of Avalokiteśvara, but certainty is not possible from the passage alone.

- The epithets of the maṇḍala deities and sacred sites in this passage are largely transliterated Sanskrit place-names and deity-names that have been rendered phonetically in the Tibetan. Several of the deity-names in the later lists are given as Tibetan translations of what appear to be Sanskrit originals now difficult to reconstruct with certainty; the renderings given here follow the apparent Tibetan semantic sense. The phrase rendered "sixteen half-portions" for the face likely refers to the sixteen phases of the moon as an iconographic convention. The passage listing the sacred sites and their associated deity-pairs corresponds to the standard list of pīṭhas found in related tantric literature, though the exact identification of several minor deity-names remains uncertain.

- The phrase rendered "the syllable Ma is the form of Venus" interprets "Śukra's form" as Venus, the planet associated with Śukra in Indian cosmology; in a tantric physiological context this may also carry the sense of seminal or vital essence, a standard double meaning in this literature.

The colours palāśa and musāragalva are left as transliterations; palāśa is the reddish-orange of the flame of the forest tree, and musāragalva is a type of coral or precious stone of reddish hue, both conventional in tantric iconographic colour descriptions.

The section on the syllables Ma, Na, Ḍa, La constitutes a standard tantric inner-maṇḍala instruction correlating mantra syllables with bodily locations and stages of the four joys; the rendering follows the literal Tibetan throughout, as the inner referents are deliberately encoded.

- The phrase rendered "the self renowned as the essential nature of the hero" reflects the tantric register in which "self" (bdag) is used throughout this passage not in the Brahmanical

sense of ātman but as a technical first-person identification with the deity — a standard Vajrayāna mode of self-generation. The repeated "I am" declarations that follow are in the same vein.

The phrase "grove of delight" renders kun dga' ra ba'i lam, literally "path of the garden of Ānanda / the grove of joy" — possibly evoking Nandana, Indra's pleasure grove, or functioning as a symbolic epithet for the maṇḍala ground.

The phrase "sap within dry wood" is a slight interpretive rendering; the Tibetan dur shing literally means "charnel wood" or "wood used in cremation grounds," but the simile parallels the oil-in-sesame and fire-in-wood images and points to the hidden presence of the self within apparent lifelessness.

The bodhisattva named lha'i dbang phyug ("Lord of Gods / Īśvara of the Gods") is left as Īśvara of the Gods rather than identified with Śiva, since in Vajrayāna contexts this is a standard bodhisattva epithet.

The final lines on mantra recitation and "churning" (srub / bsrubs) introduce a new chapter section; the churning imagery likely refers to the churning of fire through friction as a metaphor for mantra repetition generating gnosis, though the passage breaks off here.

- The passage contains dense tantric technical vocabulary whose precise system cannot always be determined from text alone. "Ālī-kālī" refers to the standard classification of Sanskrit vowels (ālī) and consonants (kālī) used throughout the Indo-Tibetan tantric tradition; rendered as "vowel series and consonant series" following the tradition.

The phrase "rke dang rkan gnyis" designates a pair of yogic channels; the exact terminology here is unusual and possibly a dialectal or abbreviated form for the two principal lateral channels (rasanā and lalanā) or the upper and lower channel openings. The rendering "upper and lower channels" follows the most common interpretive tradition.

The three proper names at the end — Lekyi Dorjema, Dorje Tshedma, and Dorje Langchenma — are Tibetan forms of Sanskrit deity names within the system described; where a fully certain Sanskrit back-formation is not possible from the text alone, Tibetan forms are retained alongside the most plausible Sanskrit equivalents noted here for reference.

- The list of sacred sites (Kāmarūpa, Mālava, Sindhu, Nāgara, Siṃhala, Mummuni, Devīkoṭi, Kulūta, Arbuda, Tālikīliba, Godāvarī, Lāmpaka, Kañcika, Karmayul, Suvarṇadvīpa, Koṅkaṇa, Vindhya, Pretasaṃghāta, Sāgaratīra, Cāriṭa, Kumārapurī, Kaśmīra, Kirāṭa, Nepāla, Kamboja, and others) are the canonical twenty-four or thirty-two pīṭha sacred sites of the yoginī-tantra system. Their assignment to specific points on the body is a standard inner-body maṇḍala mapping found in texts such as the Cakrasaṃvara cycle. The rendering follows the body-site descriptions in the Tibetan directly.

The term rendered "Mongolian-Faced Woman," "Mongolian-Eyed Woman," and "Mongolian-Headed Woman" translates "hor pa ma," "hor mig ma," and "hor mgo ma" — hor being the Tibetan designation for a Central Asian or Mongol people. This is a technical epithet of the deity, not an ethnic slur in context, but listeners should understand it as a traditional iconographic name.

The phrase rendered "Conch-Naveled Woman" for dung lte ma and related "Conch-Crested" and "Conch-Nosed" follow the literal Tibetan. These are iconographic epithets based on conch-shell symbolism.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, so the translation breaks off accordingly.

- The passage is from a tantric maṇḍala-description text, almost certainly the Cakrasaṃvara

cycle or a closely related yoginītantra. Several terms here are technical Śaiva-inflected tantric vocabulary redeployed in a Buddhist context.

"Rasket Woman" for རྩམ་ཆུ་ལྷོ་མོ་ is a genuinely uncertain reading. The Tibetan suggests something like "thick-necked" or a name compounded from རྩམ་ཆུ་ and ལྷོ་མོ་ ("thick-necked"). The name may be corrupt in transmission; the rendering is provisional.

"Caṇḍohara" (Tib. རྩམ་ཆུ་ལྷོ་མོ་) is a Sanskrit technical term used in the Cakrasaṃvara system for a specific sacred site or inner-body location; it is left untranslated as a proper name, as is standard in the commentarial tradition.

"Pīlava" (Tib. རྩམ་ཆུ་ལྷོ་མོ་) is likewise a sacred-site name within the internal maṇḍala geography; retained as a proper name.

The final line of the translated passage is syntactically incomplete in the Tibetan as given, indicating the text continues beyond the supplied excerpt.

- The phrase rendered "the cuckoo's abode" follows a tantric usage where the cuckoo is associated with a particular bodily location in the subtle body geography being described; the precise anatomical referent within the tantric system is deliberately esoteric.

The term "Uttara" in the thirteenth-day entry is left as a proper name, as it appears to be a technical tantric term or place-name within the subtle-body schema rather than the ordinary Sanskrit adjective meaning "higher" or "northern."

The final line "The distinction of joy: co-emergent joy" introduces the technical category of co-emergent or innate joy (lhan skyes dga' ba), which in Vajrayāna taxonomy is the highest of the four joys. Its appearance here signals a transition to or culmination in that highest experiential register.

- The entire passage belongs to the coded or twilight language (saṃdhyābhāṣā) register characteristic of Yoginī tantras, in which physical, cosmological, and ritual referents are systematically substituted for one another. The list of symbolic equivalences in the latter portion — beer for attachment, flesh for aversion, camphor for semen, cinnabar for blood, Nārakāpāla as a skull-cup vessel, and so on — follows a well-attested pattern in tantric feast-offering (ganacakra) literature. The term rendered "hare-bearer" is a standard poetic kenning for the moon. The phrase "fifteen-and-one" refers to the sixteenth part of the moon digit series that is the text's central numerological frame. "Ḍaṃḍi fruit" is a technical or regional term whose precise botanical referent is uncertain; it is retained in transliteration. "Arbuda" in "going is this one: arbuda" may refer to a specific hell-realm or a numerical unit; without broader context its exact application here remains uncertain.

- The passage is a chapter colophon followed by the opening of a new chapter on empowerment theory from what appears to be a Yoginī-tantra text, likely the Jñānatilaka or a closely related cycle. Several technical points deserve notice.

The phrase rendered "the Sovereign of the Gods" translates lha yi dbang phyug, which is a standard epithet applied in many tantric texts to Śiva, but here it functions as a self-designation of the tantric speaker or deity-author, likely Hevajra or a Śaiva-inflected tantric voice; this ambiguity is doctrinal, not merely translational.

The "fourteen special divisions" and "divided into eight" reflect a standard enumeration debate in Yoga and Unexcelled Yoga tantric literature regarding the number of sub-empowerments; the text itself signals that the count varies, so no emendation is warranted.

The phrase rendered "the channel of the woman and the channel born of sleep" is genuinely obscure in the Tibetan; rlung ma and gnyid skye'i rtsa likely refer to specific nāḍīs in the subtle

body system, but the precise identification is uncertain.

The final verse is incomplete as the passage ends mid-sentence; the translation follows the Tibetan faithfully to the point of truncation.

- The four syllables A, Bhi, She, Ka correspond to the four joys of the Hevajra tantric system: joy, supreme joy, joy-free, and innate joy respectively. These are technical yogic-tantric terms whose decoding here follows the standard Hevajra commentarial tradition.

The term "Rabhī" at the crown is a tantric code term; it refers to the secret syllable or deity-form associated with the cranial aperture, and is left untranslated as a technical proper name.

The phrase rendered "mother-wind" and "sleep-mother" refers to the inner winds (prāṇa) and their feminine yogic counterparts in the subtle body physiology of the completion stage; this is standard Hevajra tantric terminology.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as this is a portion of a longer continuous text.

- The passage contains several Tantric technical terms from inner-offering and tormā ritual that are left in near-transliteration by the source text itself: bha, liṅga, bhaga are Sanskrit anatomical and ritual terms used untranslated in the Tibetan, indicating the text preserves Sanskrit seed-syllables and their referents deliberately. The translation preserves this convention.

The phrase rendered "joy free from joy" reflects the technical Tantric fourfold joy schema: the text uses "dgā bral dgā" ("joy-free-joy") to indicate the fourth and highest joy, which transcends ordinary joy — a standard term in this genre.

The Blessed One "the Lady" reflects that the speaker here shifts to the Bhagavatī (the feminine form of Bhagavān), consistent with Tantric contexts where the Blessed One is a goddess figure presiding over the assembly; this is encoded in the Tibetan honorific forms.

- The chapter colophon title rendered here as "The Great Torma Definitely Taught for the Purpose of Protecting What Arises from the Glorious Gnosis-Drop" follows the Tibetan chapter heading closely; the chapter number is fifteen.

The term Īśvara (Tibetan: lha'i dbang phyug) here denotes the bodhisattva Maheśvara-Avalokiteśvara or a similarly named interlocutor in this tantric context — not the Hindu deity Śiva. The passage distinguishes this figure as a bodhisattva and great being.

The three phrases "perception of night," "perception of day," and "perception of the interval" correspond to a tantric threefold experiential taxonomy (inner luminosities or gnosis-states) that the text maps onto the three suchnesses and the structures of the drop, moon-bliss, and Great Seal. The precise doctrinal referents are specific to the source tantra's commentarial tradition and are left un-glossed in the body.

The final lines of the translated passage are incomplete as the Tibetan text breaks off mid-verse.

- The passage includes a highly technical and condensed prose section identifying aspects of suchness with various modes of consciousness, drawing on a Yogācāra-Tantric framework where the all-base consciousness, the assemblage-consciousness, and mentation-consciousness correspond to aspect, measure, and essential limit respectively. The exact text of the Jñānabindu has some unusual terminology here and the identifications are terse; the rendering follows the syntax closely.

The final section describing the charnel ground vision in terms of the goddess's bodily orifices and their terrifying attributes is a tantric inner topology. The term rendered "assemblage-consciousness" for "འཇམ་མཐོན་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་ཡི་སྒྲིབ་པ་" is unusual; it may refer to a specific Tantric category rather than a standard Vijñānavāda term, and this point is genuinely uncertain.

The final line "Division into three, division into four, division into six" is a verse-opening that belongs to the next section and is left as a line-break verse fragment consistent with the passage ending mid-verse.

- The long list of yoginī epithets and tree names in Sanskrit transliteration presents significant philological challenges. Many of the yoginī epithets are adjectival compounds rendered here as best-fit nominal forms consistent with the parallel structure of the list. Several tree names are Sanskrit loanwords preserved in Tibetan transliteration; where standard Sanskrit botanical identifications are uncertain (e.g. Aṭaputa, Dāgara, Veṇṭī, Baddaka), the transliteration is retained as given in the Tibetan without emendation. The phrase rendered "stacked and layered" for swa swa tseg tseg is an onomatopoeic reduplication that likely describes a progressive or layered dissolution process in the tantric physiological context; its precise technical meaning is uncertain. The phrase "half-word endowed with word" for phyed tshig ldan dran pa is technically obscure and may refer to a Tantric linguistic or syllabic concept connected to the dissolution of the life-breath; no confident rendering is possible beyond the literal. "Gorṣirṣa" likely corresponds to Sanskrit Gośirṣa (a species of sandalwood).
- The passage is from a tantric text (Śrī Jñānabindu, "Glorious Sphere of Primordial Wisdom") and involves highly technical Śaiva-inflected tantric yogic physiology, including the nāḍī system (lḍā, Piṅgalā, prāṇa, apāna). The enumeration of sixty-four root-channel junctions and the description of the Hūṃ syllable burning ḍākinīs of the Dharma-wheel are standard Vajrayāna subtle-body imagery and are rendered in accordance with that tradition.

The phrase rendered "the food of prāṇa and apāna is consumed" reflects the tantric prāṇāyāma practice of absorbing the breath energies inward; the Tibetan here is terse and somewhat elliptical, but this reading is consistent with the context.

"Vajrākṣa" (rendered from འཇམ་མཐོན་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་) literally means "vajra-eyed" and is the name of a tree.

- The central section of this passage is a highly technical tantric physiological description of the subtle body, including the vital channel, its proportions in finger-breadths, the placement of syllables at specific bodily locations, and the channels lḍā and Piṅgalā. The measurements given, such as twelve finger-breadths, six, half-six, and the half of sixteen, follow a system of subtle-body metrology that does not map straightforwardly onto standard Āyurvedic or mainstream tantric canonical schemes; the rendering follows the Tibetan as closely as possible without forcing spurious precision.

The phrase rendered "severed inward from the jewel's mouth" is compressed and anatomically cryptic; "the jewel" here almost certainly refers to the tip of the central channel, a standard tantric referent.

The passage on the four syllables na, ti, la, and ka, parsed as components of the Sanskrit title Jñānabindu (read as na-ti-la-ka or similar decomposition of the full title Śrī Jñānabindu), appears to be a symbolic etymology or dhāraṇī-style analysis of the tantra's title syllables; the rendering reflects this without over-specifying the exegesis.

- The passage enumerates sixteen grounds beyond the standard ten bodhisattva grounds, a schema characteristic of certain Vajrayāna tantric systems rather than standard Mahāyāna ground theory. The sixteenth ground described as "beyond examination" reflects a tantric apex

transcending conceptual categorisation.

The list of thirty-two bodily substances toward the end of the passage is a standard Indic anatomical enumeration; several terms overlap (blood and flesh each appear twice in the Tibetan), which is reproduced faithfully rather than smoothed over.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the provided Tibetan; the translation ends accordingly.

- [illegible]

The final stanza is genuinely cryptic. The line "In the sequence of the truths, different from those of the dissolved elements — the bodily form: it does not exist anywhere" renders a dense technical statement about the dissolution of elements and the non-location of the body-form in that context. The precise philosophical referent may belong to a broader tantric system not fully recoverable from this excerpt alone.

The phrase rendered "free of intoxicants" for chang dang bral could also be read "free of alcohol / fermented drink," which in tantric context may signal a non-literal or sublimated interpretation of the seminal fluid as bodhicitta.

- The Tibetan "འདྲི་བརྒྱུད་ཀྱི་མཆོག་པོ་ལྷ་སྐྱོང་མཁན་པོ་ཡི་སྤྱོད་པོ་" is a feminine form, "the Blessed Lady Great Seal," a tantric goddess-figure functioning as an interlocutor alongside Vajrasattva in this assembly. Her gender is marked by the feminine suffix -ma, and the passage records that she experiences regret at her own question. The translation renders this consistently as "the Blessed One, the Great Seal" in flowing prose; the femininity is preserved contextually where the grammar indicates it.

The passage dealing with "blood" and the enumerated joys at the opening is dense inner-tantric physiology, distinguishing the substance and the experience-states of the mystic body from the ultimately inexpressible intrinsic nature. The translation follows the literal sense without importing commentary.

- The phrase rendered "Six-Adorned" refers to a song whose opening words are "druk den" (six-adorned or six-featured), likely referring to Vajrapāṇi's six ornaments or attributes; the song's proper incipit is preserved here as a title cue rather than a full verse.

The passage describing the arising of the goddesses through the sequence beginning with "rubbing and being rubbed" is a highly compressed tantric description of the emergence of maṇḍala deities through the process of sexual yoga and the arising of bliss-gnosis; the technical sequence (contraction, expansion, extension, equal union) corresponds to the four joys in the Cakrasamvara and related tantric systems. The translation renders this faithfully

without interpolation.

The final line breaks off mid-sentence in the source; this is a textual lacuna or the passage simply ends here in the given excerpt.

"Eighty-two marks of wisdom" renders "brgya gnyis blo ldan byad gzugs can," where brgya gnyis (literally "hundred-two," i.e., 102 or eighty-two depending on textual tradition) refers to the marks and signs of a great being; this is a genuine ambiguity in the numeral, which may be $80+2 = 82$ or may reflect a different count. The rendering "eighty-two" follows the most natural reading.

- The passage contains explicit tantric sexual yoga imagery, rendered faithfully in accordance with the text. The "bird-faced one" refers to a dākinī figure associated with the wisdom channel lḍā, here named directly. The "fourth fruit" refers to the fourth empowerment in the standard four-empowerment schema of the higher tantras, which confers recognition of the nature of mind through the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. The term rendered "pericarp" for རྩུབ་པ་ is a technical term for the central seed-pod portion of a lotus in maṇḍala construction; the Tibetan is a transliteration of Sanskrit, and its precise Sanskrit original is not fully certain — "pericarp" follows the most common commentarial understanding. The "Lotus Navel" in the listing of heroes refers back to the Buddha's own name given in the preceding chapter. The "God of Desire" is Kāmadeva (Skt. kāmadeva), the deity of sensual love.

- The passage on the four joys, joy free from joy, and innate joy reflects a standard Vajrayāna scheme of four ānandas found in the Yoginī tantras: joy (ānanda), supreme joy (paramānanda), joy free from joy (viramānanda), and innate joy (sahajānanda). The technical discussion in the Blessed Lady's question is deliberately compressed and somewhat cryptic, as is conventional in tantric dialogue; the rendering follows the Tibetan closely without smoothing over the intentional obscurity.

The term koṭi-pāla and hālu in the Blessed Lady's question appear to be Sanskrit loanwords used in a technical or perhaps coded tantric sense; their precise referents are uncertain in this context and may belong to a specialized commentarial tradition not fully recoverable from the passage alone.

The mantras are rendered in transliteration exactly as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering; they are not normalized to classical Sanskrit since the phonetic forms in the text are the liturgically authoritative forms.

- The passage shifts from a scene of celestial homage and song into a highly technical tantric exposition of yogic physiology, syllable-by-syllable hermeneutics, and subtle-body practice. The iḍā and piṅgalā are the two principal side channels of tantric physiology, left and right respectively. The "churner and churned" refers to the method of inner heat practice involving two channels or energies in friction. "The six root conjunctions" and related terms belong to the Yoginī-tantra system of subtle-body practice; exact doctrinal identification of each term depends on the specific commentarial lineage of this text. The final portion opens a new chapter whose chapter number is not yet given in the excerpt and whose list of topics is cut off at the end of the passage.

- The passage is a chapter-colophon followed by a new chapter's question-and-answer sequence from a Vajrayāna tantra, likely the Jñānabindu-tantra or a related text in the Cakrasaṃvara cycle. The numerical series — thirty-six, thirty-seven, thirty-eight, thirty-nine, forty — refers to progressive enumerations of tantric topics or deity-principles within the system of the tantra, and their precise doctrinal referents depend on the specific commentarial tradition.

The final verse fragment ends abruptly mid-sentence with the donkey-face and its terrifying sound, suggesting the passage is cut at a chapter boundary. The "donkey-face" is a recognized iconographic feature in certain fierce forms of yoginī deities in the Cakrasaṃvara and related cycles.

The line rendered "other supreme speech-paths are inexpressible" is genuinely dense; the Tibetan reads literally "the other-supreme speech-path is unspeakable," which in context means that beyond the gnosis of the forty there is nothing further to articulate.

- The phrase rendered "at the Joyous Lotus" translates "dgyes padma," which may be a place-name, a throne, or an epithet; the context is ambiguous. The interpretation here follows the most natural reading given the surrounding liturgical context.

The expression "the third fragment, all-encompassing" (dumbu gsum pa kun dang bzhi) is syntactically compressed and potentially corrupt; the translation renders the most contextually coherent reading without forcing a false precision.

The "twelve wisdoms without birth" and "twelve goddesses" are characteristic enumerations of this class of tantra and are rendered according to their most natural doctrinal value without further expansion, as the text does not gloss them here.

- The names of the four goddesses in the cardinal directions and the four in the corners are given in Tibetan transliteration of Sanskrit names that are only partially reconstructible from the text as transmitted. I have rendered them in approximate Sanskrit form where the construction is clear (e.g. Vajrabhairavī, Vajraḍombinī); several others remain opaque in the received Tibetan and are rendered as closely as possible. A critical edition with Sanskrit witness would clarify these.

The phrase rendered "second body-type" for "འཕྲུལ་གྱི་འཕྲུལ་ལྔ་པ་" is technically ambiguous; it may refer to a specific iconographic class or to a secondary emanation form. The exact technical denotation is uncertain without a commentary.

The lines on the pāṭali tree and lunar seats reflect a laconic listing of subsidiary deities whose full identities would be supplied by a practitioner's commentary; the translation follows the text closely without expanding.

- The verse section presents interpretive challenges throughout. The opening line "hard to find, incomparable, beyond all Victors" is syntactically compressed in the Tibetan and may be read as describing either the retinue themselves (transformed by the Protector's grace) or the teaching they have received. The rendering follows the most natural grammatical reading, with "we" as the subject transformed by the Protector's kindness, though the qualities listed are paradoxically those of the ultimate nature being praised.

The colophon phrase "sbyor drug gi grags pa bcu dang bral ba bcu gsum" — "the ten renowned and thirteen separated aspects of the six unions" — is a highly technical Yoginī tantra formulation. The translation renders it literally; its precise referents belong to the specialized commentarial tradition of this tantra and are not unpacked here.

The final line "zhu thig g.yar khral bgyis so" indicates that a copy was made on loan at Sakya, a common colophon note indicating the manuscript's provenance and transmission circumstances.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.